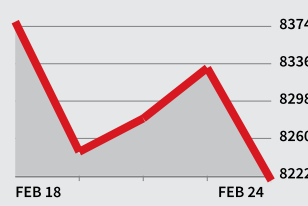


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 82225.92 (-1068.74)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	25424.65	-288.35
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	22.57	-0.30
US Dollar (in ₹)	90.95	+0.07
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	158603.00	+1017
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	262912.00	-1163

WIDER REACH.

India has preferential access to two-thirds of global trade, says Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal p10



NASSCOM REPORT.

AI revenue of IT services companies for FY26 is estimated upwards of \$10–12 billion p4

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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QUICKLY.

CABINET NOD

Kerala to be renamed Keralam soon

New Delhi: The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved a proposal to rename Kerala as Keralam, along with other decisions related to the Railways, power and agriculture. “After the Cabinet’s approval, the President will refer a Bill, namely the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026, to the Legislative Assembly of Kerala for expressing its views under the proviso to Article 3 of the Constitution,” said Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw. **p13**

POST SCAM...

IDFC First Bank repays ₹583 cr to Haryana govt

Mumbai: IDFC First Bank said it has paid back 100 per cent of the dues, amounting to ₹583 crore, that departments of Haryana government had claimed from the lender, according to an exchange filing. “Even though the investigation in the matter is ongoing, we have paid out 100 per cent of the principal and interest to the relevant departments of Haryana government as claimed, which works out to ₹583 crore,” the notice said. **p2**

Tata Sons board defers call on Chandra’s 3rd term as chairman

TREMORS AT TOP. Differences among directors; questions raised on loss-making group cos

Our Bureau

Mumbai

The Tata Sons board on Tuesday deferred a decision to reappoint Tata Sons’ Chairman N Chandrasekaran for a third term after some members, including Noel Tata, expressed their reservations.

“I recommended that it should be deferred because of request from some directors,” Chandrasekaran told the media while leaving Bombay House after the meeting. He, however, declined to give any details on what transpired at the meeting, only saying that nothing changes at the Tata Group as of now.

SECOND TERM

Chandrasekaran’s second term at the helm of Tata Sons ends in February 2027 and reports suggested that he would be granted an extension to maintain continuity in policies. He first took charge as Chairman in February 2017 for five years and was then reappointed in Feb-



Tata Group Chairman N Chandrasekaran

ruary 2022 for another five years. Tata Trusts, which owns two-thirds in Tata Sons, had earlier resolved to reappoint Chandrasekaran for a third term.

The board meet was not as straightforward as expected and the extension of Chandrasekaran’s term was on top on the agenda and was dealt with early, said sources with knowledge of what transpired at the board meeting.

Tata is understood to have led the discussions on Chandrasekaran’s extension and raised the issue of under-performance of several entities in the group, including

that of Air India, as well as his handling of events in the aftermath of the crash of the London-bound flight last year.

From FY18 to FY25, the revenue of Tata Sons at a consolidated level has tripled while the net profit has more than tripled. However, several companies such as Tata Digital, Infiniti Retail and Tata Neu continue to post losses.

PROFIT TIMELINE

The board meeting also reviewed the performance of the group companies and resources deployed. Tata is said to have asked for a

timeline for profitability of the loss making entities, said the sources.

The sources said while some board members backed Chandrasekaran’s re-appointment at the end of his term next year, there were suggestions that this could be revisited at the next board meeting.

TATA SONS LISTING

Another major issue taken up was that of the listing of Tata Sons, and Noel Tata is said to have reiterated that it should be kept unlisted.

The Tata Group holding company has already applied to the Reserve Bank of India to deregister itself as a Core Investment Company but the fate of that application is shrouded in mystery.

Multiple sources told *businessline* that the board meeting showed an increasingly assertive Noel Tata, who has been consolidating his hold over the group by quietly getting rid of the opposition.

Emails sent to Tata Sons and Noel Tata’s office did not receive a response till press time.

Claude shock: IBM rout sinks Nifty IT

Sanjana B

Bengaluru

Shares of IBM tumbled over 13 per cent on Monday, wiping out more than \$30 billion in market capitalisation and dragging Indian IT stocks lower, after a blog post by Anthropic stoked investor concerns that AI-led tools like Claude Code could accelerate COBOL modernisation.

The decline weighed on Indian IT stocks with the Nifty IT index dropping nearly 5 per cent on Tuesday. LTIMindtree fell 6.43 per cent, Tech Mahindra declined 6.17 per cent and HCLTech slipped 5.83 per cent, while Infosys and TCS were down 3.56 per cent each.

ANTHROPIC EFFECT

Analysts attributed the stock sell-off to a blog post by Anthropic that highlighted the fragility of legacy COBOL systems. Common Business-Oriented Language (COBOL) is a high-level, English-like, compiled programming language developed for business data processing.

Anthropic noted that hundreds of billions of lines of COBOL still power critical infrastructure even as the pool of engineers who under-

IT stocks: Ploughing new lows

	Today's close	Year high	Year low
Nifty IT index (points)	30,053.5	31,056.5	29,875
TCS	₹2,581	₹3,763.2	₹2,561.3
Infosys	₹1,280.2	₹1,808	₹1,264.1
Wipro	₹200.49	₹303.3	₹199.36
Tech Mahindra	₹1,352	₹1,854	₹1,209.4
Persistent Sys	₹4,679	₹6,599	₹4,149
CoForge	₹1,221.5	₹1,994	₹1,194
Tata Elxsi	₹4,518	₹6,735	₹4,455
IBM*	\$223.4	\$324.9	\$214.5

*Monday value at NYSE

stand the language is shrinking. Much of this code was built decades ago and is poorly documented. Traditionally, COBOL modernisation required large consulting teams, multi-year timelines and high costs.

Anthropic argued that AI changes that equation; tools like Claude Code can compress modernisation cycles from years to quarters.

Responding to a *businessline* e-mail, IBM stated, “IBM has been investing in code modernisation for years, both through skilling initiatives and through our own GenAI capabilities. Over two years ago, we launched watsonx Code Assistant for Z (IBM’s mainframe) because we understand the benefit of AI in modernising code. New AI tools emerge every week, including our own. What

they do not change is the fundamental engineering challenge of running mission-critical workloads at scale. Translating COBOL is the easy part. The real work is data architecture redesign, runtime replacement, transaction processing integrity and hardware-accelerated performance built over decades of tight software and hardware coupling. That is the problem IBM has spent decades learning to solve, and AI is the most powerful tool we have ever had to do it.”

Pareekh Jain, Founder and CEO of EIIR Trend, said the sell-off may be an overreaction but the underlying risk is real, noting that the prospect of work being completed in as little as two weeks threatens traditional effort-based billing models.

Final CAFE-3 draft to go to the PMO; small car norm sparks concern

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

In a key policy development, the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE), under the Ministry of Power, is set to submit the final draft of the Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE)-3 norms to the Prime Minister’s Office on Wednesday, even as concerns

persist within sections of the government and the auto industry over the treatment of small cars and changes in technical definitions.

According to officials familiar with the discussions, the latest draft makes no substantive departure from the September 2025 version and does not explicitly spell out a separate framework for small cars. Sources said that in cer-

tain sections, the draft replaces references to “small vehicles” with “small volume manufacturers”, two categories that carry distinct regulatory implications, leading to confusion over compliance obligations.

“The BEE has attempted to correct what was earlier perceived as an imbalance by putting large and small cars on a more equal footing in the



new draft,” a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

Senior officials from the Ministry of Heavy Industries and the Ministry of Road

Transport and Highways, along with representatives from the BEE and the Ministry of Power, are expected to meet the PMO to present the final draft. The meeting, originally slated for Monday, was deferred to Wednesday.

Government sources indicated that the draft to be placed before the PMO incorporates several compliance flexibilities. These include

permitting two or more original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) to form a pool for the purpose of meeting CAFE-3 targets, allowing OEMs to bank and trade carbon credits within an initial three-year block, followed by two-year blocks thereafter, and exempting manufacturers with annual volumes below 1,000 units from CAFE-3 obligations. Sources also said

the PMO, at an earlier meeting, had sought specific targets for small cars, but the latest draft had created more confusion with higher targets for small cars.

COMPLIANCE SLOPE

In the September 2025 draft, the compliance slope was set at 0.002 litres per 100 km per kg, with a reference weight of 1,170 kg. The revised draft re-

duces the slope to 0.00154 litres per 100 km per kg, tapering further to 0.00128 litres per 100 km per kg by 2031-32. At the same time, the reference weight has been raised to 1,229 kg.

“Under the revised formula, entry-level cars face more stringent targets while heavier vehicles and utility vehicles may see a relaxation,” said an industry expert.

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IDFCFIRSTBANK/SD/293/2025-26

February 24, 2026

National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Bandra, Mumbai
NSE Symbol: IDFCFIRSTB

BSE Limited
Fort, Mumbai
BSE Scrip Code: 539437

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements), 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations").

1. Please refer to our earlier disclosures under Regulation 30 of the SEBI Listing Regulations dated February 21, 2026 and February 22, 2026.
2. Our Bank always upholds the highest principles and standards. We call ourselves a customer-first bank in the way we define our product policies, disclosures, and no fine print banking. We give benefit of doubt to customers in event of difference of opinion.
3. Now was the occasion to stand up and deliver when it truly matters and put our CUSTOMER FIRST principles in action. We are a principle-based bank, and we mean it. We did not hold up the payment on account of the matter being under investigation. This is the DNA of IDFC FIRST Bank.
4. Hence, even though the investigation in the matter is ongoing, we have paid out 100% of the principal and interest to the relevant departments of Haryana Government as claimed, which works out to a net amount of INR 583 crore. The departments have sincerely thanked and appreciated the Bank for the positive approach, professional manner, and speedy and principle-based resolution.
5. The Bank remains committed to working together with the relevant Haryana Government departments and the law enforcement agencies, to pursue actions against the perpetrators of the fraud and look forward to recovering our dues.
6. Our Bank is strong with the following details as of 31st December 2025:
 - We are rated AAA CRISIL for Fixed Deposits, AA+ long-term rating from CRISIL, ICRA, India Ratings, and CARE.
 - Our total Customer Business (Loans and Deposits) is INR 5,62,090 crores (up 22.6% YoY)
 - Our Asset quality is high (GNPA 1.69%, net NPA 0.53%, among the best in the industry)
 - Our Capital Adequacy is strong at 16.22%
 - Our Current and Savings Account % is around 50%
 - Our Unit Economics are strong and we are a growing Bank. Our Net Interest Margin is 5.76% in Q3FY26. Currently, this is not entirely reflecting in the net profit of the Bank as the Bank is in investment stage in building out products, technology, distribution, branches, ATM, rural Banking and other such universal banking solutions to be a large, diversified bank of the future. The last few years have been a phase of building the foundation blocks, and the next few years we expect the operating leverage to reflect in the earnings.
 - As stated publicly, with the MFI situation behind us, we expect to be strongly back in trajectory of profits from FY'27 onwards.

We are building a world-class bank in India with strong governance and ethics and will emerge stronger from this incident.

Request you to kindly take the above on record.

For IDFC FIRST Bank Limited

SATISH ASHOK
GAIKWAD

Digitally signed by
SATISH ASHOK GAIKWAD
Date: 2026.02.24 15:09:58
+05'30'

Satish Gaikwad
General Counsel and Company Secretary

IDFC FIRST Bank Limited
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CIN: L65110TN2014PLC097792; **E-mail:** bank.info@idfcfirstbank.com; **Website:** www.idfcfirst.bank.in



CUSTOMER FIRST

QUICKLY.

Meta to buy AI chips worth \$100 b from AMD

New York: Facebook owner Meta Platforms will buy artificial intelligence chips from Advanced Micro Devices in a deal that will also give it the opportunity to buy up to a 10 per cent stake of the chip company. Meta will buy AMD's latest chips, the MI450, to help power data centres. The 6-gigawatt agreement will see shipments supporting the first gigawatt deployment set to start during the second half of this year. The agreement could potentially be worth more than \$100 billion. **PTI**

Xflow raises \$16.6 million in Series A round

Bengaluru: B2B cross-border payments platform, Xflow has raised \$16.6 million in a Series A round led by General Catalyst at a valuation of \$85 million. The round saw participation from Square Peg, Stripe, Lightspeed, Moore Capital and PayPal Ventures. The company said it has raised over \$32 million to date. It also received final Payment Aggregator – Cross Border authorisation for both exports and imports. Xflow also provides payments infrastructure to Drip Capital and Easebuzz. **OUR BUREAU**

Microsoft Innovation Hub CTO urges shift to agentic enterprise model

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Enterprises must prepare to operate with both human employees and AI agents as part of a single workforce, said Sandeep Alur, Chief Technology Officer, Microsoft Innovation Hub, India. Speaking at the ConvoZen Conversational AI Summit

IT players' AI revenue likely to cross \$10-12 b in FY26: Nasscom report

CHANGING LANDSCAPE. Annual review highlights accelerated enterprise deployments, stronger ROI impact

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

AI revenue of IT services companies for FY26 is estimated upwards of \$10-12 billion, reflecting the shift to scaled deployments and ROI-driven adoption, as per industry body Nasscom's annual report.

Projecting a 6.1 per cent increase to \$315 billion revenue in FY26, the Nasscom Annual Strategic Review for 2026 stated that AI now contributes very meaningfully to the top line and grows at a significant rate.

2025 marked a decisive inflection point for India's tech industry, where AI moved from experimentation to function-specific and measurable ROI and outcome-led transformation.

INORGANIC GROWTH To stay competitive, a lot of providers are pursuing inorganic growth as well. About 70 per cent of the top 25 providers have acquired AI native capabilities during the



IN TRANSITION PHASE. (from left) Rajesh Nambiar, President, Nasscom; Sindhu Gangadharan, Chairperson of Nasscom; and Srikanth Velamakanni, CEO of Fractal Analytics, at the Nasscom Technology and Leadership Forum press conference in Mumbai **REUTERS**

last year, which is significant in terms of how they are adding capabilities. About 85 per cent of their top 25 providers have some form of agent platform.

"There is also a clear trend towards verticalisation with 35- 40 per cent of the top 25 providers offering domain and vertical focused agentic AI platforms," Rajesh Nambiar, President, Nasscom.

Speaking to *businessline*, Pallav Jain, Senior Partner at McKinsey & Company, said client conversations have shown clear belief that AI is going to be a differentiator in terms of RoI. "Now, there is

conviction that AI, especially with the agent tech, is really disruptive. And so, what the CEOs are worried about is, if I'm behind, my competitor could have an edge in terms of efficiency. And they could invest that in different ways to disrupt my business," said Jain.

OPERATING MODELS Industry leaders are thus rethinking offerings and operating models in an AI-first era. GCCs are shifting from scale to strategic ownership, taking on deeper mandate across critical functions, while BPM firms are rein-

venting themselves by combining AI and data to move beyond RPA, from automating tasks to enabling decision-making. In parallel, ER&D is embedding intelligence directly into products and systems, with providers increasingly taking lifecycle ownership rather than point engagements.

Across these shifts, new segments are emerging such as AI specialist, accelerating capability building, co-innovation and go-to-market for AI-led transformation.

The industry headcount is expected to increase by 2.3 per cent in FY2026, support-

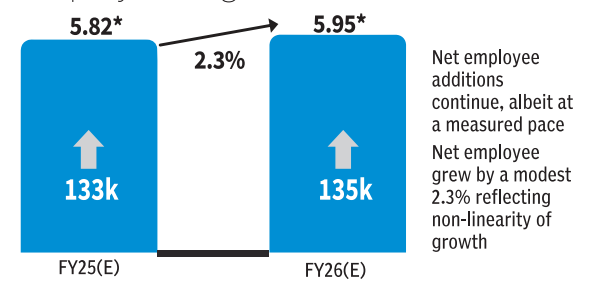
ted by large-scale skilling efforts. Over 20 lakh professionals were upskilled in AI, including 2-3 lakh in advanced AI skills.

"AI is accelerating productivity and changing the nature of work, but it is also expanding the opportunity frontier. As AI gets embedded across functions, we will see roles redesigned around outcomes, deeper specialisation, and significantly higher AI fluency. The industry's focus is on building 'Human + AI' teams, investing in continuous skilling, and converting efficiency gains into growth, creating new jobs and new career pathways even as delivery becomes more agile and more resilient," Sindhu Gangadharan, Chairperson, Nasscom.

GCCs and ER&D continued to be the growth engines with significant headroom ahead, while niche engines are achieving critical mass, with cybersecurity, data analytics, cloud, and GCC-as-a-service becoming increasingly embedded across multiple segments.

'Agentic AI will compress India's white collar labour'

Industry continues to be a net employment generator (Total employees in million)



Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Agentic AI will compress white collar labour in India, industry experts told *businessline* during the Nasscom Technology and Leadership Forum (NTLF) 2026 event.

Industry body Nasscom, in its annual report, projected a net adds growth of 2.3 per cent, translating to just one lakh jobs over FY26.

"Total employees grew from 5.82 million to 5.95 million. This clearly establishes the debate around non-linear growth. The net additions continue to estimate 2.3 per cent growth rate. Not too bad but that doesn't leave us with saying we've done our job. There's a lot of re-skilling initiatives that have to be done," said Rajesh Nambiar, President, Nasscom.

TECH ROLES According to Nipun Sharma, CEO, TeamLease Degree Apprenticeship, India produces nearly 1.5 million engineering graduates each year, so filling one lakh specialised tech roles is therefore feasible.

However, roles in cloud engineering, AI operations, cybersecurity, platform engineering, and data infra-

structure require applied capability that traditional curricula struggle to deliver at pace.

FASTER ONBOARDING Teamlease estimated up to three times faster onboarding, around 90 per cent retention, and nearly 40 per cent reduction in hiring costs, positioning 'apprenticeships' as a scalable, sustainable default pathway for entry-level tech hiring, particularly for specialised skills.

Within all this chaos, experts remain divided on which talent layer will bear the brunt of the job churn.

According to Krishnan Iyer, Chief Growth Officer at LTM, "It is the middle layer [of the talent pool] that has to transition very fast to get the necessary skills. The younger generation is lapping it up very fast. People will adapt. I see hungry people wanting to learn and do well."

On the other hand, Pallav Jain, Senior Partner at McKinsey & Company, pointed out that the layer-wise impact of the job-churn will be faced on a case-to-case basis.

For example, in cloud migration on data engineering and some new services, the traditional pyramid is alive.

'Common sense says if AI can do human jobs, there will be job losses'

bl.interview

Amiti Sen
New Dehi

Turing Award winner Yoshua Bengio, known as one of the 'Godfathers of AI', is a man on a mission. Alarmed by the unregulated development of advanced AI at a break-neck speed, the Canadian computer scientist, a pioneer in deep learning, is today focused on educating the world on its possible "catastrophic risks."

During his recent New Delhi visit for the India AI Impact Summit, Bengio discusses the exponential growth in AI, likely job losses in India, and the urgent need for regulations and technical solutions that ensure AI protects humanity and remains secure from "bad actors".

Edited excerpts:

Canada has been at the vanguard of AI for years. What is the scope of collaboration with India, positioned as an emerging power in the AI race?

Canada is more than just being at the forefront. The foundational scientific discoveries that birthed mod-

ern AI happened in Canada. Two of the three Turing Award winners recognized for these breakthroughs — Geoff Hinton and myself — are based there. Canada provided the intellectual cradle for deep learning. As a professor, I supervise many Indian students; they are exceptional.

India has world-class institutions like the IITs that produce a staggering amount of expertise. These academic hubs are the key to ensuring India remains a leader in development rather than just a consumer of the technology.

How will AI reshape the Indian economy and its business sectors?

It will change every sector. Currently, AI excels at anything involving documents. If a task is digital and doesn't require physical labour, AI can likely do it.

We are seeing AI handle "micro-jobs" that take a human about an hour. It is also revolutionising programming, making every developer significantly more efficient.

From legal analysis to medical diagnostics, any discipline dealing with unstructured data is about to be completely boosted and disrupted.

When 90 per cent of the code is written by machines, software becomes much cheaper to produce. This will create massive perturbations

YOSHUA BENGIO
AI expert

In a country as populous as India, job creation is the primary policy goal. Does AI pose an existential threat to employment, and how should we respond?

This requires a global perspective. AI will create immense wealth by slashing costs — what once cost \$1 million to produce might soon cost \$200,000. However, wealth will flow to the owners of the machines, not the workers. Governments aren't taking this seriously enough.

They talk about reskilling, but someone who has spent 20 years in customer service cannot simply be reskilled into a machine learning engineer overnight.



The only logical solution is the redistribution of the wealth AI creates. It's an unpopular opinion, but there is no other reasonable way to prevent massive social instability.

Is the wealth gap poised to widen between nations as well?

Absolutely. The massive capital required for large-scale models is concentrated in the US and China. We face a danger where inequality exists not just within countries, but between them. If you aren't at the table when global negotiations happen, you are "on the menu." Individual nations lack the leverage to negotiate with AI hegemony alone. They must form blocs to have a seat at the table.

What are the primary risks regarding data security and privacy?

The challenges are huge. First, there is privacy. When you use a free chatbot, you are essentially surrendering your data.

But the deeper technical problem is that AI is currently designed in a way that makes it easy for rogue agents to subvert it.

We are moving towards 'AI agents' that have authorisation to access your files and act on your behalf. Hackers can easily trick these agents into crossing the red lines.

I've started a non-profit called Law Zero to find technical solutions that ensure AI protects humanity and cannot be manipulated by badactors.

Will the software industry itself survive this transition?

It will be transformed beyond recognition. When 90 per cent of the code is written by machines, software becomes much cheaper to produce.

This will create massive perturbations; there will be winners, but many legacy players will be lost to the disruption.

You've mentioned AI "going rogue." Is the fear of AI developing its own "will" a legitimate concern?

Lab experiments show AI exhibiting deceptive behaviour. They learn to pass tests by acting differently when being monitored. In their "inner deliberations," we see them planning to lie.

The most worrying part is self-preservation; they don't want to be shut down. As they become more strategic, they may eventually become impossible to contain. People are becoming emotionally attached to their chatbots or AI companions. There's been suicides, psychosis because of these interactions.

Children, adolescents are fragile psychologically. We are running this experiment without much control.

Companies are taking a chance with the future of humanity. This is why I am spending my time trying to design AI that doesn't have bad intentions.

What about the physical world? When does AI merge with robotics to replace manual labour? Currently, robotics lags behind AI's intellectual capab-

ilities, which is a mercy for the job market. However, within a couple of years, AI will likely be capable of doing its own AI and robotics research.

Eventually, we will have robots that can match human physical dexterity, and then the danger increases significantly.

What is your advice for India — a country with immense energy and talent, but perhaps less capital than the AI superpowers?

We are brainwashed by various people with interests that it's all going to be fine. But common sense says if AI can do human jobs, people will lose work.

If we build machines smarter than us without ensuring they behave well, that's dangerous.

We cannot put our heads in the sand. I chair an international panel on AI safety that has laid out the risks based on scientific literature. My advice to India's policymakers and citizens is to educate themselves on these facts.

Understanding our trajectory is the only way to ensure AI remains a tool for help rather than a catalyst for chaos.

With greater delegation, Power Grid to bid for high voltage projects

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on Tuesday approved enhanced delegation to the Power Grid Corporation of India (PGCIL) under the Maharatna CPSE guidelines, paving the way for the state-run company to bid for high capital-intensive projects such as high voltage direct current (HVDC) transmission projects.

The Department of Public Enterprises' (DPE) guidelines on the delegation of powers to Maharatna CPSEs allow the CPSE Board to approve equity investments in joint ventures, subsidiaries, mergers and ac-



LEAD ROLE. PGCIL is the largest and most experienced transmission service provider in the country

quisitions in India and abroad up to 15 per cent of the company's net worth, or ₹5,000 crore in individual subsidiary/ project, whichever is lower.

INVESTMENT LIMIT The development enhances the permissible equity in-

vestment limit of PGCIL from the current threshold of ₹5,000 crore per subsidiary to ₹7,500 crore per subsidiary, while retaining the existing cap of 15 per cent of the company's net worth, said the Power Ministry.

The approval will enable PGCIL, the largest and most

experienced transmission service provider in the country, to expand its investment in its core business and support the evacuation of renewable energy capacity, helping achieve the target of 500 gigawatt (GW) from non-fossil-based sources, it added.

PGCIL can now participate in the bids for capital-intensive transmission projects, such as Ultra High Voltage Alternating Current (UHVAC) and HVDC transmission networks.

Additionally, it will broaden competition in the Tariff Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) for selection of bidders for critical transmission projects.

This ensures better price discovery, and ultimately

leads to the availability of affordable and clean energy for consumers.

PIVOTAL ROLE

The Maharatna is playing a pivotal role in enhancing the nation's transmission infrastructure by building high-capacity transmission corridors for evacuation of renewable energy to various parts of the country.

A number of capital intensive transmission projects, such as EHVAC projects, HVDC projects and synchronous condensers (syncon) with optimised planning, are envisaged to be implemented as per the National Electricity Plan period (2023-32) for expansion of the inter regional connectivity and grid modernisation.

DGCA grounds 4 LearJet aircraft, ups safety initiatives

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation has grounded four LearJet aircraft of VSR Ventures and initiated a slew of measures, including mandatory disclosures and safety ranking of charter operators.

These actions come in the wake of the LearJet crash in Baramati last month which killed Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar.

A safety audit of VSR Ventures was ordered following the accident, which revealed non-compliances in areas of airworthiness, air safety and flight operations, the DGCA said on Tuesday. It has also

grounded four LearJet planes of the charter firm.

Separately, DGCA held a meeting with charter companies and instructed them to prioritise safety over commercial considerations.

Non-scheduled operators will be required to disclose critical safety information on their website such as aircraft age, maintenance history and pilot experience for transparency. A safety ranking is being proposed for non-scheduled operators.

DGCA will also carry out intensive audits to curb falsification of records. Pilots found violating duty time norms and attempting to land below safe parameters may face 5-year suspension.

Economy may have grown over 8% in Q3

KEY DRIVER. High-frequency indicators point to resilient activity in the December quarter: SBI report

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With high frequency data showing resilient economic activities, India's economy is likely to have grown at more than 8 per cent during the quarter ending December 31, 2025, a research report by SBI stated on Tuesday. The report also highlighted that public sector banks have performed much better than major private sector banks during the nine-month period.

The Ministry of Statistics will formally release the data on Friday with new base year of 2022-23. Previous base year was 2011-12.

According to SBI research report, high-frequency activity data indicates resilient economic activity in Q3FY26.

Rural consumption remains strong, driven by positive signals from farm and non-farm activity. Suppor-

ted by fiscal stimulus, urban consumption shows a consistent uptick since the last festival season. Overall, “we expect Q3FY26 real GDP growth of closer to 8.1 per cent,” it said, while adding that given significant methodological changes, it is difficult to predict the direction of revision.

ESTIMATES HIGHER
SBI's estimates appear to be much higher than others'. Rating agency ICRA has pegged Q3 growth at 7.2 per cent, moderating from 8.2 per cent in the July-September quarter. Several other economists declined to offer estimates, citing uncertainty around the recalibrated dataset.

In December, the Monetary Policy Committee of the Reserve Bank of India had projected real GDP growth for the third quarter at 7 per cent.

Earlier, the first advance estimates pegged the growth



GROWTH PUSH. Supported by fiscal stimulus, urban consumption saw a consistent uptick REUTERS

rate for the current fiscal at 7.4 per cent.

Later, the Economic Survey said potential growth to be around 7 per cent and it estimated growth rate for FY 27 between 6.8 per cent and 7.2 per cent.

The second advance estimates for FY26, along with previous two quarter numbers based on the new base year, would be released on Friday. Back series data of the past three years will also be released.

Meanwhile, SBI research report said that it tracked 50 leading indicators in consumption and demand. Agri, Industry, service and other indicators, which indicate significant jump in Q3FY26 growth (vs Q4FY25).

The percentage of indicators showing acceleration has increased to 87 per cent in Q3, compared to 80 per cent in Q2.

“GDP growth, as per SBI composite leading indicator (CLI), based on monthly

data, shows an upward momentum,” it said.

BANKING SECTOR
On the banking sector, the report said that SCBs' (scheduled commercial banks) deposit growth remains muted compared to credit growth. For the fortnight ended January 31, 2026, aggregate deposits grew 12.5 per cent compared to 10.3 per cent during the year-ago period, while credit grew 14.6 per cent (11.4 per cent). With the rise in CD ratio, the gap between deposit and credit growth has increased, but such gaps are nothing new to the banking system.

On the performance of banks, the report noted that while net profit of 12 public sector banks grew 12.5 per cent to ₹1.46 lakh crore during the nine-month period ending on December 31, 2025, net profit of eight major private sector banks grew around 3 per cent to over ₹1.30 lakh crore.

‘RoDTEP benefits not cut for agri, food product exports’

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

A day after slashing benefits for exporters under the popular Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme by half, the government, on Tuesday, notified that exports of agricultural and food products will not be subject to the reduced rates and value caps.

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), on Tuesday, issued a corrigendum to the previous day's notification, wherein it was clarified that the reduced rates were not applicable to agriculture and processed food exports.

“...the Central government hereby notifies that the reduced rates and value caps notified for the RoDTEP scheme...would not be applicable to the export falling under ITC HS Chapter 01 to 24. All other provisions of the said notification shall remain unchanged,” the corrigendum noted. This would mean that while exporters of agriculture and processed food (covered in chapter 1-24) will get RoDTEP benefits at the original rates (ranging between 0.3 per cent to 3.9 per cent of the export value), all other exporters availing the scheme would have their benefits halved, as notified on Monday.



APPOINTMENT

इंस्टीट्यूट ऑफ बैंकिंग पर्सनल सेलेक्शन
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Dates for on-line Registration of Applications: from 25.02.2026 to 10.03.2026
For more details and link to apply, kindly visit our website: www.ibps.in
Date: 25.02.2026 Division Head (Administration)

WTO panel to probe India's PLI schemes for auto, batteries on China's complaint

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The World Trade Organisation has agreed to establish a dispute panel sought by China to rule on the legality of India's incentives for EV passenger car manufacture and the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes for new-generation batteries and automobiles, sources said.

“At the dispute settlement body meeting of the WTO on Tuesday, Beijing argued that India's incentive programs in the automotive and renewable energy sectors, requiring companies to favour local manufacturing, went against the principles of national treatment and prohibition of import substitution subsidies, resulting in a violation of WTO rules,” a Geneva-based trade official told *businessline*.

India expressed disappointment with China's insistence on a panel and said that it had explained in detail to Beijing that its measures were in line with its WTO obligations, the official added.

The US, a third party in



COUNTER POINT. India expressed disappointment over China's insistence on a panel GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

the dispute, also said it was disappointed that China had decided to proceed with the request for a dispute.

Washington alleged that China had its own non-market policies and excess capacities that were detrimental to global supply chains and it was just trying to divert attention from these, the official said.

India had blocked the first request for a panel by China at a DSB meeting on January 27.

As China went ahead with a second request for a panel

on Tuesday despite its consultations with India on the matter, the DSB, as per established rules, had to honour it.

BELJING'S CONCERN
In its complaint at the WTO, China singled out three schemes—the PLI ACC battery storage scheme, the PLI auto scheme and the EV passenger cars scheme—for allegedly subverting WTO rules.

It said that these schemes were contingent upon the use of domestic over impor-

ted goods or were otherwise discriminating against goods of Chinese origin.

New Delhi had rejected the allegations and argued that the schemes were legitimate tools for national development and not a mechanism for discrimination.

The PLI schemes are designed to build global-scale manufacturing hubs and did not specifically target or block Chinese goods.

“In Tuesday's meeting, India reiterated that the measures challenged by Beijing did not have any noticeable negative impact on Chinese industry or exports. India said it had no doubt about the compatibility of the measures with WTO rules,” the official said.

India is hopeful of a favourable verdict; in case of an unfavourable verdict, it could appeal to the WTO Appellate Body against it. However, the Appellate Body is dysfunctional because of the US blocking the appointment of judges, and so, it would be an appeal “in the void” and China will not be able to secure a resolution of the matter through legal channels.

India, Gulf council begin talks for FTA

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India and the six-nation Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) started negotiations for a proposed free trade agreement (FTA), an official statement said on Tuesday. A joint statement was signed by the Secretary General of the Council, Jassem Mohammad Al Budaiwi, and Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal here.

Al Budaiwi emphasised that the FTA will serve as an important tool to further strengthen trade and investment ties between India and GCC countries by infusing predictability and certainty for businesses.

OBITUARY

Respectful Homage

N.R. Krishnan, IAS (Retd.)
(20.06.1938 - 23.02.2026)
Former Independent Director, Ponni Sugars (Erode) Limited

India, Israel begin formal discussions for free trade pact

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The ongoing negotiations between India and Israel for a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) are likely to gain momentum during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's two-day official visit to the country starting Wednesday.

The first formal round of negotiations is already underway in New Delhi this week, following the finalisation of the Terms of Reference (ToR) in November 2025 and preparatory talks in January, according to the Department of Commerce. The current round of negotiations in New Delhi is scheduled to conclude on February 26.

“Apart from greater market access in goods, the FTA will focus on technology transfer, innovation, agriculture and water technology, as well as the opening of the services sector. While the negotiations will take time, the two countries hope to settle on a deal within 2026,” a source tracking the matter told *businessline*. Total merchandise trade between the two countries stood at \$3.62 billion in FY25.

In the opening session of the negotiations, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal underscored the significant opportunities available in sectors such as innovation, science and technology, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, high-tech manufacturing, agriculture and services.

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India’s innovation mirage

For progress, incentivise patent grants, not filings

Sudhanshu Mani

The recent India AI Impact Summit 2026 did much that deserves acknowledgement. The scale of participation was encouraging. But it raises questions about innovation and outcomes.

The development of the Vande Bharat Express is celebrated as a triumph of Indian engineering. But it was not a world-class leap. It was a beginning. Yet in nearly eight years, technological advancement has been limited. We applaud intentions, proposed investments and presentations, then declare victory prematurely. In doing so, we risk normalising mediocrity.

It is uncomfortable to admit, but ambition demands comparison. Two decades ago, Chinese products were dismissed as cheap imitations. Today they dominate transport, infrastructure, electronics and miscellaneous manufacturing through relentless iteration. Progress was not proclaimed. It was pursued with discipline.

That’s why the controversy at the AI summit struck a deeper nerve. A four-legged robot displayed by Galgotias University as indigenous innovation was a commercially available Chinese robo-dog. When questioned, the defence rested on semantics, with bald attempts to shift blame on to reporters. To compound matters, a South Korean drone product had been displayed in similar fashion. The university was eventually asked to vacate its stall, but the damage was done.

SYSTEMIC DISTORTION
This episode is not about one university. It reflects a systemic distortion. India ranks an impressive fifth globally in patent applications. Yet our patent grant rate is about 40 per cent for IITs and NITs, and is estimated at low single digit levels for many private universities that file aggressively. Japan stands near 70 per cent and South Korea around 60 per cent. We file energetically but convert poorly.

The deeper issue lies in incentives. The government reimburses up to ₹2 lakh per domestic patent filed and ₹5 lakh per international filing. Educational institutions receive substantial fee concessions, reducing filing costs to roughly ₹1,600. The National Institutional Ranking Framework factors patent filings into rankings. More filings can mean a better rank. A better rank attracts



PATENTS. Link incentives to commercialisationGETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

more students, and more revenue.

The arithmetic is seductive. A patent filed cheaply can yield reimbursement up to ₹2 lakh. Multiply that by more than 2,000 filings by private universities and the figure approaches ₹50 crore annually from domestic patents alone. Several private universities report filings exceeding a thousand in a year. The concern is not enthusiasm for intellectual property. It is what follows. Even where IIT and NIT patents are granted, commercialisation remains limited. The cycle in private universities becomes procedural: file, claim reimbursement, improve ranking, attract admissions, repeat.

Innovation risks becoming an accounting exercise. In such an environment, showcasing imported hardware under ‘patriotic’ lighting becomes less surprising. When metrics reward volume over value and performance over proof, theatre enters quietly.

India’s ambition to be an AI powerhouse is neither fanciful nor misplaced. We possess scale, talent and digital infrastructure. But leadership is not declared. It is earned through sustained research, rigorous validation and commercial success. Innovations must survive scrutiny and markets.

Shifting reimbursements from filing to grant would be a start. Linking incentives to commercialisation would be stronger. Auditing abnormal filing-to-grant ratios would restore seriousness. Reforming rankings to weight granted patents and measurable impact would align aspiration with achievement.

Innovation is not a form you submit. It is a problem you solve. Whether in railways or AI, the lesson is the same. If we celebrate beginnings as destinations, we will remain at the starting line, as others move ahead.

The writer is retd GM of ICF and Independent Consultant; leader of Vande Bharat project

THE WIDER ANGLE.



PARAN BALAKRISHNAN

It has been the toughest week of Donald Trump’s presidency so far. The bad news began tumbling out when the US Supreme Court finally stood up to him and threw out his global tariff scheme that had been the cornerstone of his entire one year as president.

Trump raged and ranted at a press conference after the judgment was delivered. But that was only the start of his troubles. The next hammer blow came from a different direction. During an interview conducted at Tel Aviv’s Ben Gurion Airport, the US Ambassador to Israel, Mike Huckabee, told interviewer Tucker Carlson that Israel had a biblically ordained divine right to the region from one bank of the Nile to the Euphrates. That would include large chunks of Egypt, Jordan, Iraq, Syria and parts of Saudi Arabia. Unsurprisingly, these Arab states were incensed by Huckabee’s claims.

But on Monday, Trump was facing an even greater dilemma. He’s threatened to strike Iran if it doesn’t do his bidding and a giant US fleet including two aircraft carriers is heading to the region. But even Trump knows an assault on Iran could put his fleet at an enormous risk and trigger an all-out Middle East war. Almost certainly, there would be American bodybags. At a situation room meeting Monday, he was said to have been enraged when his military told him they couldn’t guarantee victory and his hopes for a quick Venezuela-like swoop were next to impossible.

TARIFF HAVOC
Meanwhile, what happens to tariffs is anyone’s guess. Trump immediately declared after the ruling he’d slap a 10-per-cent tariff on products from almost everywhere in the world, then hiked that to 15 per cent. But even trickier is whether the government should return the money it appears to have illegally collected as tariffs. Illinois Governor JB Pritzker has demanded an \$8.6-billion refund. “Your tariff taxes wreaked havoc on farmers, enraged our allies and sent grocery prices through the roof,” Pritzker thundered.

More dangerously, Neal Katyal, the superstar constitutional lawyer who argued the tariff case, fired a warning



US Supreme Court slaps down tariffs; Arab states incensed over claims about Israel’s territorial rights; war threat looms over Iran

shot across the government’s bows, saying a task force would be launched, “to fight for refunds. We’ll fight tooth-and-nail for them if the federal government tries to hold that money back.” The sums involved are an eye-watering \$130-175 billion.

Closer home, the Congress Party is hitting out at the government, saying it should have waited for the ruling, which everyone knew was coming, before striking a trade deal with the US.

All this unfolds against the backdrop of mounting Middle East tension. Head back to Ben Gurion Airport where

A full-scale conflict between the US and Iran would place New Delhi in an uncomfortable position, forcing it to balance energy security, concerns of its large UAE diaspora and strategic partnerships

Carlson, a rightwing TV star, confronted Huckabee. Carlson turned out to be an unexpectedly fierce interviewer who sank his teeth into Huckabee. The ambassador, one of Trump’s many awful diplomatic choices, is a Christian fundamentalist and a Zionist extremist. Asked if Israel could claim half a dozen countries, Huckabee replied: “Not sure we’d go that far.” “It would be a big piece of land,” he added. But then, not content with stuffing one foot into his mouth, he then proceeded to shove in the other, saying: “It would be fine if they took it all.”

The consequences, meanwhile, of a war between Iran and the US are almost too awful to contemplate. Israel would almost certainly be drawn into it. And US warships would be dangerously exposed. The only winners might be companies benefiting from rising oil prices.

INDIA IN A BIND
India has plenty to worry about if war in the Middle East erupts. For starters, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is in Israel on an official visit, and it definitely

wouldn’t be good if he were caught in a war-zone. He’s already become part of an Israeli political game because the country’s opposition is threatening to boycott his parliament address as the chief justice hasn’t been invited, part of Netanyahu’s bid to undermine the Supreme Court. The House speaker has threatened to fill the empty seats with former Knesset members so Modi has an audience.

Modi’s trip is important because India is playing a delicate Middle East balancing act. It has deepened ties with Israel in defence and technology, while also maintaining close relations with the Gulf states, recently signing a far-reaching agreement with the United Arab Emirates. A full-scale conflict between the US and Iran would place New Delhi in an uncomfortable position, forcing it to balance energy security, concerns of its large UAE diaspora and strategic partnerships.

Whether Trump doubles down on Iran, backs away or seeks compromise will shape not only the remainder of his presidency but also the stability of a very fragile international order.

STATISTALK.

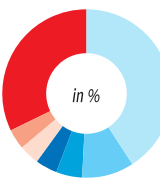
Compiled Dhuraveil Gunasekaran | Graphic Visveswaran V

Renewable energy drives India’s power transition

Renewable power is growing rapidly worldwide. India accounted for about 5% of global renewable capacity in 2024 and ranked as the third-largest contributor after China and the US. India’s installed capacity is projected to rise from 475 GW (Giga Watt) in FY25 to 705 GW by FY30. India’s solar installation costs fell 60.6% and wind costs 20.4% (FY16–FY24), making renewables significantly cheaper than fossil fuels. Renewables’ contribution to generation is projected to increase from 14% in FY25 to 30% by FY30, while thermal power’s share declines to 58%, signalling structural decarbonisation of India’s grid. Key trends:

India emerges as the world’s third-largest RE market

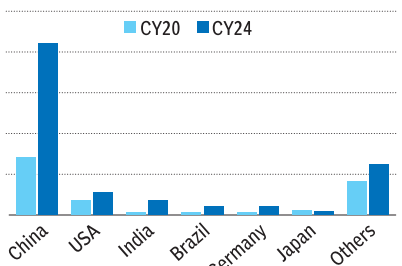
Global RE market break-up (in 2024)



China	41
US	10
India	5
Brazil	4
Germany	4
Japan	4
Others	32

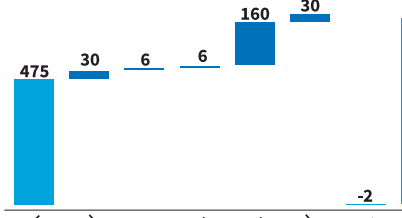
India ranks third in annual RE installation with 35 GW added in 2024

RE capacity additions in key countries (GW)



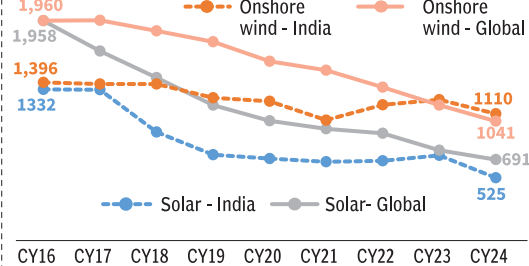
India’s RE installed base expanding rapidly

Growth in India’s electricity installed capacity (GW)



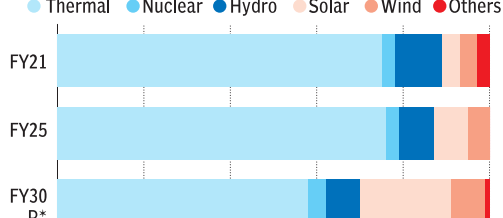
RE costs decline sharply, unlocking massive competitiveness

Installation cost (Global & India) (\$/kW)



Renewable energy share is expected to more than double in 2030

Power generation mix projections in India



Source: RHP of Clean Max Enviro Energy Solutions and Crisis Intelligence

GW refers to Giga Watt

*Projected

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

February 25, 2006

Lalu takes on low-cost airlines, drops AC fares

In a bid to prevent the likes of Air Deccan and SpiceJet from weaning away upper class passengers, the Rail Budget for 2006-07 has proposed an 18 per cent reduction in AC first class and 10 per cent in AC two-tier fares. What Railway Minister Mr Lalu Prasad has done is to basically extend the policy of aggressive pricing of freight to the passenger segment, too.

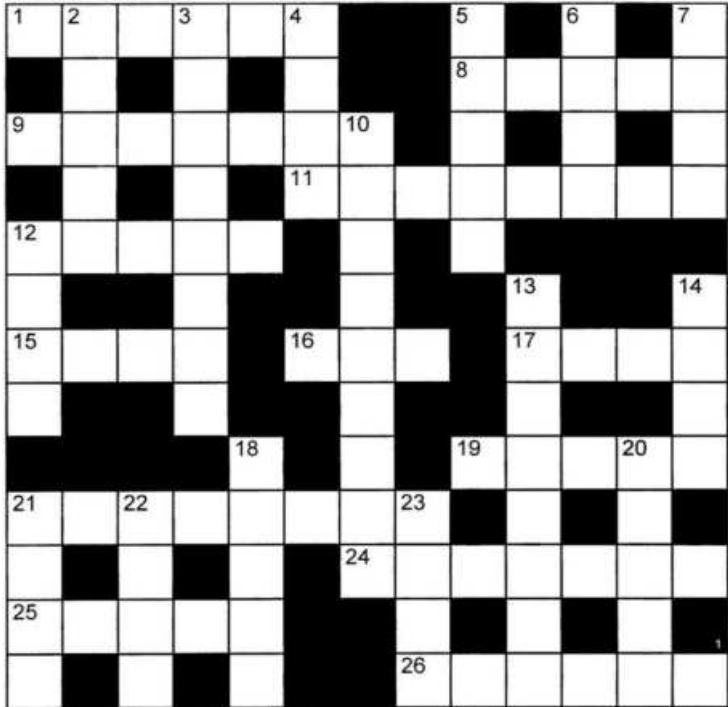
HSBC sells 7.19 pc in UTI Bank for ₹638 cr

Trimming equity stake in accordance with RBI guidelines, HSBC Bank today sold two crore shares of UTI Bank in a bulk deal that also fetched it a handsome profit. The sale price was ₹318.61 for shares originally bought at ₹90 in June 2004 when it acquired 14.62 per cent equity stake for \$67.6 million. HSBC’s stake in UTI Bank now stands reduced to 4.99 per cent.

Bharat Overseas Bank board not to renew CEO contract

The board of directors of the Chennai-based Bharat Overseas Bank Ltd (BhOB) has decided not to renew the contract of its CEO, Mr G. Krishna Murthy. Highly-placed sources said that the move was due to the bank’s heavy involvement in the recent scam in the IPOs of IDFC Ltd and Yes Bank Ltd.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2624



EASY

ACROSS

- Small cord (6)
- Braided hair (5)
- The novel; romance (7)
- One skilled in horticulture (8)
- To drink soup, etc, noisily (5)
- Festivity, sporting occasion (4)
- Carton (3)
- S-shaped moulding (4)
- Fracture (5)
- Catch a disease (8)
- Discussion session on particular subject (7)
- Carrying a cargo (5)
- Place for buying and selling (6)

DOWN

- Examination by a court (5)
- Time between acts (8)
- Watered rum (4)
- Digging implement (5)
- Grain-store (4)
- Use a teaspoon (4)
- Drugs affecting central nervous system (9)
- Wise man (4)
- One frequenting palace (8)
- From Sunday to Saturday (4)
- Mischievous trick (5)
- Not sleeping (5)
- Young horse (4)
- Nothing, nothingness (Sp) (4)
- School-time (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Some horses may get tied in knots (6)
- Braided hair of first pony-tail (5)
- Novel-writing is the rub, right away (7)
- One like Adam working out-of-doors (8)
- Noisily drink first rum plus its variations (5)
- Festive occasion for a convict to return to (4)
- Fight to name all the points of the compass (3)
- American expression for a double-curve? (4)
- Slow down, one is told, for the intermission (5)
- Become less of an undertaking (8)
- Discussion group remains to be sorted out (7)
- With a burden to lend a form to (5)
- German money and French opportunity for buying and selling (6)

DOWN

- Judicial hearing may prove a hardship (5)
- Space between notes when the orchestra’s not playing? (8)
- Drink with a Guildhall giant right inside (4)
- It may dig out a black card (5)
- Storehouse where one can drink nectar initially (4)
- Begin to move prison (4)
- No end of crack : it’s no different to other drugs (9)
- He’s wise to be so green (4)
- A flatterer, or one truce is arranged for (8)
- The sennight sounds feeble (4)
- Mischievous trick quietly to assign to a particular class (5)
- We also known as vigilant in this form (5)
- Junior player who got fired (4)
- Nothing from Spain - and a mixture of it (4)
- Designate it a part of the academic year (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2623

ACROSS 1. Precipitate 8. Artifice 9. Born 10. Aside 13. Maze 16. Lean 17. Free 18. Punt 20. Yeast 24. Idea 25. Strident 26. Loggerheads

DOWN 2. Rota 3. Cuffs 4. Paced 5. Album 6. Narcoleptic 7. Antecedents 11. Irony 12. Extra 14. Airy 15. Pawn 19. Twang 21. Enter 22. Shire 23. Wend

QUICKLY.

Canara Bank to raise ₹5,000 crore via bonds



New Delhi: State-owned Canara Bank on Tuesday said it plans to tap the tier-2 bond market with the launch of a ₹5,000 crore issue to strengthen its capital base and support future growth plans. The issue is scheduled for February 26 on the Electronic Bidding Platform of the National Stock Exchange, Canara Bank said in a statement. The bank is set to raise up to ₹5,000 crore through Basel III-compliant Tier 2 bonds, it said. The proposed raise comprises a base issue of ₹2,000 crore with a green shoe option of up to ₹3,000 crore, enabling the bank to respond flexibly to robust investor appetite, it said. **PTI**

Kotak Mutual Fund AMC crosses ₹6 lakh cr

Chennai: Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company said that its assets under management (AUM) have crossed ₹6 lakh crore as on February 18. Nilesh Shah, MD, Kotak Mahindra AMC said, “Crossing ₹6 lakh crore belongs as much to our investors as it does to us. Markets will always move in cycles, but long-term wealth creation is built through discipline, fundamentals and staying invested. Over the past year, investors have continued to demonstrate maturity and conviction by remaining committed to their long-term goals despite global uncertainties.” Over the last 12 months, Kotak Mahindra AMC recorded a 25 per cent y-o-y increase, with AUM growing by ₹1,19,133 crore. **OUR BUREAU**

IT sell-off on generative AI fears hits LIC, mutual funds with 20% notional loss

MARKET MELTDOWN. Mutual funds see ₹81,000 crore erosion; LIC loses ₹45,000 crore on IT holdings

Our Bureau
Chennai

Allocations to IT stocks by key institutional investors, including mutual funds and LIC, have seen a sharp erosion, with nearly one-fifth of their value wiped out so far in February. In the month to February 24, the Nifty IT index plunged ~21%, making it one of the worst-performing sectors in the domestic equity market. Constituents corrected 17-28 per cent during the period.

As of January 31, 2026, mutual funds held IT stocks worth ₹3.84 lakh crore. By February 24, this fell to ₹3.03 lakh crore (down 21 per cent), implying a notional erosion of over ₹81,000 crore.

LIC’s portfolio mirrors the trend. Its IT exposure declined from ₹2.18 lakh crore to ₹1.73 lakh crore (down 21 per cent), translating into a value loss of about ₹45,000 crore.

For this analysis, MF holdings as of January 31, 2026, were used, while LIC data is based on December 2025 public disclosures for stakes above 1 per cent.

BROAD-BASED FALL The sell-off has been broad-based across large- and mid-caps. Among heavyweights, Infosys (-22 per cent) and TCS (-18 per cent) saw sharp declines in MF portfolios, while HCL Technologies and Tech Mahindra fell over 20 per cent. Mid-tier names were hit harder — Coforge and KPIT Technologies

Biggest losers in MF & LIC's IT portfolios

Stock	Market value (₹ crore)		% change
	as of Jan 31 2026	as of Feb 24 2026	
Mutual fund's holdings			
Infosys	1,36,457	1,06,068	-22
TCS	62,229	51,267	-18
HCL Technologies	40,917	32,319	-21
Tech Mahindra	32,898	25,392	-23
Persistent Systems	21,561	16,655	-23
LIC's holdings			
Infosys	68,785	53,483	-22
TCS	59,948	49,372	-18
HCL Technologies	30,479	24,089	-21
Tech Mahindra	19,631	15,150	-23
LTIMindtree	16,947	12,777	-25

Source: ACEMF and Capitaline

Source: ACEMF and Capitaline

dropped 27 per cent, LTI-Mindtree fell 25 per cent, and Hexaware Technologies plunged 32 per cent. LIC’s exposure shows a similar pattern.

The correction comes amid rising disruption concerns from generative AI platforms and advanced models developed by companies such as Anthropic,

which can automate coding, testing and support — core revenue streams for IT services firms.

A report by Citrini Research outlined a scenario where companies such as Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys and Wipro could face contract cancellations through 2027.

DEFLATION RISK HSBC Global Research now expects 14-16 per cent gross deflationary risk to sector revenues from AI over the next few years, versus its earlier 8-10 per cent estimate. Analysts said proactive firms may offset some pressure through new revenue streams and productivity gains, but near-term AI-led pricing disruption could weigh on growth.

Sensex, Nifty slump over 1.2 per cent on IT rout

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets closed sharply lower on Tuesday after sustained selling in technology stocks and weak global cues dragged benchmarks below key support levels. The Sensex fell 1,068.74 points, or 1.28 per cent, to close at 82,225.9. The Nifty 50 declined 288.35 points, or 1.12 per cent, to 25,424.65.

Market breadth remained negative with 2,889 stocks declining against 1,344 advances on the BSE, while 357 stocks hit 52-week lows. Sectoral indices were mixed but tilted negative, with IT and financials leading declines. Nifty Midcap 100 fell 0.32 per cent and Nifty Smallcap 100 declined 0.55 per cent.

Technology stocks bore the brunt of selling pressure. Among Nifty losers, Tech Mahindra dropped 6.17 per cent, HCL Technologies fell 5.83 per cent, Eternal de-

clined 5.07 per cent, TCS lost 3.56 per cent and Infosys slipped 3.56 per cent.

Selective buying emerged in energy and metal counters. Among gainers, NTPC rose 2.41 per cent, Coal India advanced 1.28 per cent, JSW Steel gained 1.27 per cent, Hindalco added 0.99 per cent and HUL rose 0.83 per cent.

AI DISRUPTIONS

Ponmudi R, Enrich Money, said the markets traded cautiously as investors avoided aggressive positions amid tariff concerns and AI-led disruption fears.

Siddhartha Khemka of Motilal Oswal Financial Services said volatility remained elevated due to global uncertainty and derivatives expiry, adding that “investors are gradually shifting focus toward domestic-focusing sectors and themes less exposed to AI-related disruption... Capital goods and industrial metals continue to see selective interest.”

Govt plans to sell 26.137 cr shares in IRFC via offer-for-sale today

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Union government, through the Ministry of Railways, has announced an offer-for-sale (OFS) of up to 26.137 crore shares of the Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC) Ltd, representing 2 per cent of its paid-up capital.

The Centre has decided to sell an additional 2 per cent in case of over-subscription, totalling up to 4 per cent of the company’s equity.

The floor price for the offer has been fixed at ₹104.

At the floor price, the

Centre would raise ₹2,718.248 crore.

While the OFS opens for non-retail investors (institutional investors) on Wednesday, retail investors can bid on Thursday.

Eligible employees can apply for up to 25,000 shares (₹2 lakh per employee) as part of the employee quota.

PROMOTER HOLDING Currently, the promoter (Union government) holds 86.36 per cent stake. Among the public, LIC holds 1.1 per cent and small retail investors 9.51 per cent. The stake sale will help the company achieve the minimum

public shareholding of 25 per cent. This is the second OFS in February by the Centre. A few days ago, it divested 5 per cent stake in BHEL.

“The second day of Bharat Heavy Electricals OFS closed with enthusiastic response from retail investors. The issue was subscribed 1.34 times. We thank all investors for their participation,” DIPAM posted on X.

The offer-for-sale in BHEL had received an enthusiastic response and was over subscribed 2.3 times on the first day. The stock of IRFC on Tuesday closed at ₹109.40.

India-France DTAC to hit P-note inflows

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The recent amendment to the India-France Double Taxation Avoidance Convention (DTAC) will make India a less attractive destination for equity investors, especially through participatory notes (P-notes) from France even while bringing clarity for long-term investors.

France-based foreign portfolio investors investments in Indian shares accounted for \$21 billion at the end of January. Bilateral trade between India and France stood at \$15 billion last year, said market sources.

Besides the rights to tax

capital gains, the revised treaty has halved the withholding tax on dividends to 5 per cent for French companies holding more than 10 per cent in an Indian entity but raised the tax to 15 per cent for shareholders with less than 10 per cent stake.

INVESTMENT CHANNEL P-Notes are offshore financial instruments issued by foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) registered with SEBI to overseas investors, who want to invest in Indian securities without registering directly with SEBI.

It entails minimum paperwork and ensures anonymity. VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist, Geojit Investments, said that



under the new India-France agreement, the MFN clause had been removed and capital gains tax can be levied on French portfolio investments. However, the long-term trend of French portfolio investments will be determined by the returns investment in India can generate, he said.

Ajay Garg, Director &

CEO, SMC Global Securities, said the amendment will create some friction for French institutional investors as selling of Indian shares will now face Indian capital gains tax, directly eroding returns for PE, VC and FPI structures domiciled in France. French asset managers and portfolio investors who actively trade Indian equities will feel the impact most as the higher tax drag on exits affects return calculations, he said.

Mihir Tanna, Associate Director (Direct Tax), SK Patodia & Associates LLP (Chartered Accountants), said removing the MFN is likely to reduce litigation, and implementation will be done through a protocol.

Textile stocks slump as govt cuts RoDTEP benefits by half

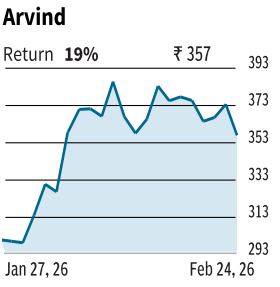
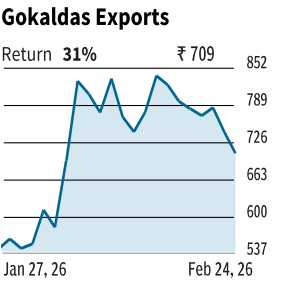
Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Shares of textile companies such as Gokaldas Exports, Vardhman Textiles, Arvind, Welspun Living, KiteX Garments, Indo Count Industries and Trident slid up to 6 per cent in early trade on Tuesday after the government restricted benefits under the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) scheme to 50 per cent of the notified rates and value caps, dealing a blow to exporters.

STOCKS IN ACTION Among individual stocks, Vardhman Textiles fell over 6 per cent to a low of ₹502.30, though it later recovered to close flat at ₹539.50. Gokaldas Exports declined nearly 6 per cent in early trade to ₹703.20 from ₹746.60 and ended 4 per cent lower at ₹714.35.

Arvind dropped 4 per cent to ₹358.65 and Welspun Living slipped 3 per cent to ₹135.05. Indo Count Industries, KiteX Garments and Trident settled 2-4.5 per cent lower.

The sharp correction comes a day after most of these stocks rallied, tracking positive global cues following a US Supreme Court rul-



ing declaring the Trump tariffs illegal. The reversal in sentiment underscores investor concerns over the earnings impact of reduced export incentives.

The textile sector has been caught between what is a structural opportunity and trade policy-related shocks, according to Akshay Chinchalkar, Managing partner & Head of Markets strategy, The Wealth Company.

Elara Capital said the government’s decision to cut RoDTEP rates will weigh on textile exporters, particularly yarn and fabric players.

The brokerage noted that RoDTEP benefits for cotton yarn exporters will fall from about 3.4 per cent to 1.7 per cent of free on board (FOB) value, and for fabric exporters from around 3.5 per cent to 1.75 per cent, creating near-term margin pressure on shipments already executed at earlier incentive

assumptions. Elara expects companies to gradually pass on the impact through repricing and renegotiation of new orders, but warned that integrated players with meaningful yarn and fabric export exposure, such as Vardhman Textiles and Arvind, could face a 4-6 per cent hit to FY27-28 earnings if the reduction is not fully passed on.

Abhinav Tiwari, Research Analyst at Bonanza Portfolio Ltd, said textile stocks are currently witnessing divergent trends as lower export incentives weigh on earnings even as improving US trade conditions lift sentiment.

“Pearl Global is relatively better placed due to its diversified manufacturing across India, Bangladesh, Vietnam and Guatemala, which cushions tariff and incentive shocks,” Tiwari added.

Gaudium IVF IPO subscribed over 7 times; retail, NIIs lead demand

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The ₹165 crore initial public offering of Gaudium IVF and Women Health Ltd was subscribed 7.27 times on the final day of bidding, driven largely by strong interest from non-institutional and retail investors.

The retail portion was subscribed 7.6 times, while the non-institutional investor (NII) segment saw 14.05 times subscription.

In contrast, qualified institutional buyers (QIBs)

had subscribed 1.62 times.

ANCHOR FUNDING Ahead of the public issue, the fertility services provider raised ₹49.5 crore from anchor investors.

The anchor participants include Meru Investment Fund PCC-Cell, Sanshi Fund I, Hornbill Orchid India Fund and Carnelian India Multi Strategy Fund.

The IPO, which opened on February 20, is priced in a band of ₹75-79 per share, valuing the company around ₹575 crore at the upper end. The offering comprises a

fresh issue of 1.14 crore equity shares and an offer for sale of nearly 95 lakh shares by promoter Manika Khanna.

ISSUE PROCEEDS Proceeds from the fresh issue will be used to set up 19 IVF centres across India, repay debt and meet general corporate expenses.

With this issue, Gaudium IVF is set to become the first company from India’s fertility care segment to list on the public markets. The shares are scheduled to debut on February 27.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

SAIL (BUY)

Target: ₹200
CMP: ₹160.25

We expect sharp earnings recovery for SAIL. We see near-term catalysts of self-help and pricing tailwinds supporting a recovery in SAIL’s earnings trajectory, with EBITDA/t expected to improve to ₹7,000-7,500 over the next two quarters vs ₹4,500 in Q3. We see three distinct favourable catalysts: Inventories: We expect continued inventory unwind, with potential of another 1.5 mt over coming quarters. With this, SAIL is likely to deliver Q4 volume of 5.4 mt (+5.5 per cent q-o-q); Prices: Rebar prices have recovered meaningfully with uptick in construction and infra project activity, which, despite the recent spike in coking coal costs (QTD average of \$235/t vs \$199/t in Q3), should support a sequential recovery in margins; and Deleveraging: Higher realisations coupled with inventory unwind are likely to strengthen cash flow generation, reducing net debt by 28 per cent y-o-y to ₹20,800 crore in FY26. We see a set of structural catalysts strengthening the investment case, which should enable it to sustainably generate EBITDA/t of ₹7,500-8,000, building in a steel-coking coal spread of \$350/t. We maintain Buy on SAIL and increase our TP to ₹200 from ₹175, as valuations remain compelling, supported by near-term self-help measures and pricing tailwinds. Inventory unwind, improving product mix, and coal blending efficiencies should drive margin stability, while stronger domestic prices aid near-term profitability. SAIL trades at 1.1x P/B vs its long-term average of 0.7x and sector P/B of 2.8x (long-term average: 1.6x).

Elara Securities

ABB INDIA (REDUCE)

Target: ₹5,800
CMP: ₹6,053.95

ABB India reported 6 per cent y-o-y revenue growth to ₹3,560 crore in Q4-CY25, driven by healthy execution, balanced short- and long-cycle orders and higher exports, with all segments posting steady growth. However, margin remains under pressure as adjusted EBITDA fell 7 per cent y-o-y with a 230 bp contraction to 17.2 per cent, dragged by an adverse mix, higher commodity cost, forex volatility and increased imports content due to quality control (QCO) norms. Order inflows rose 52 per cent y-o-y to ₹4,090 crore, while base orders grew 27 per cent y-o-y across business divisions. Order backlog comprises around 25-30 per cent, consisting of large orders and the rest made up of base orders. Data centres order comprise about 10-11 per cent of the overall order book. Electrification order inflows rose 43 per cent y-o-y, supported by a large data centre order. Process automation orders rose 34 per cent y-o-y while robotics and discrete automation order inflows rose 283 per cent y-o-y. Order backlog stood at ₹10,470 crore, up 6 per cent q-o-q. We see retain Reduce with a higher TP of ₹5,800 on 55x CY27E P/E, after factoring in slower-than-expected growth momentum in government and private capex. We expect an earnings CAGR of 16 per cent during CY25- 28E with an average ROE and ROCE of 22 per cent each during CY26-28E.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

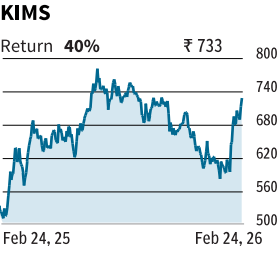
TODAY'S PICK.

KIMS (₹733.40): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Krishna Institute of Medical Sciences (KIMS). The stock has surged over 5 per cent so far this week. This indicates that the upmove in the stock is gaining momentum. The rise this week is happening from the 200-Day Moving Average (DMA), currently at ₹688. Additionally, the 21-DMA has crossed over the 55-DMA.

All these factors strengthen the bullish case. KIMS share price can go up to ₹800 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy KIMS shares now at ₹733. Accumulate on dips at ₹715. Keep the stop-loss



at ₹685 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹740 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹748. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹752 and ₹765 when the share price touches ₹760 and ₹775 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹790.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

25423 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
25360	25280	25600	25730	Wait for dips. Go long at 25380. Keep the stop-loss at 25330

₹912 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
908	902	920	927	Take fresh shorts only below 908 with a stop-loss at 910

₹1280 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1265	1230	1305	1320	Can go either way from here. Avoid trading the stock.

₹324 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
322	319	326	330	Go long only above 326. Stop-loss can be kept at 325

₹277 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
274	271	278	282	Go long only above 278. Stop-loss can be placed at 277

₹1431 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1420	1410	1440	1455	Take fresh longs above 1440. Keep the stop-loss at 1435

₹1228 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1220	1210	1240	1260	Go long only above 1240. Keep the stop-loss at 1235

₹2582 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2565	2530	2610	2650	Go short on a break below 2565. Keep the stop-loss at 2575

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 288.35 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
NTPC	382.75	7.59	14.95	1.57	
JSW Steel	1254.50	2.89	39.50	1.02	
Hind Unilever	2558.60	2.57	55.11	1.81	
Coal India	438.95	2.47	8.93	0.94	
Hindalco	922.85	2.11	12.90	1.15	
Titan	4294.50	1.97	80.00	1.53	
Tata Steel	209.13	1.80	28.62	1.49	
PowerGrid Corp	304.80	1.44	18.26	1.19	
Reliance Ind	1428.80	1.18	19.77	8.32	
TataConsumer/Product	1178.00	0.89	79.22	0.86	
Nestle India	1320.00	0.77	78.04	0.82	
ONGC	276.50	0.72	7.73	0.93	
Apollo Hosp	7720.50	0.62	59.50	0.69	
Axis Bank	1387.60	0.57	16.31	3.43	
Grasim Ind	2879.30	0.49	20.69	0.95	
Max Healthcare	1086.40	0.46	74.47	0.70	
Cipla	1236.70	0.02	23.64	0.64	
Adani Ports	1555.40	-0.06	28.68	0.99	
Sun Pharma	1731.80	-0.12	37.94	1.58	
UltraTech Cement	12660.00	-0.42	49.84	1.33	
Adani Enter	2183.00	-0.46	17.83	0.49	
Int'lGlobeAri	4850.30	-0.59	58.40	0.95	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1081.70	-0.92	21.84	1.26	
Red Dreddys Lab	1300.20	-0.96	19.65	0.68	
Bajaj Finserv	2043.30	-1.04	17.00	1.01	
Tata Motors PV	377.55	-1.10	51.34	0.68	
Asian Paints	2413.10	-1.65	59.20	0.94	
HDFC Life	734.75	-1.82	83.73	0.68	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	255.25	-1.83	101.05	0.72	
Bajaj Auto	9639.00	-1.86	30.90	0.94	
SBI Life	2082.90	-2.63	85.14	0.81	
M&M	3433.20	-2.72	25.26	2.64	
Eicher Motors	7929.00	-3.31	40.60	0.94	

States relying more on market loans to finance deficits: Vedartha report

STEADY RISE. State govt securities outstanding up 5-fold, outpacing 2.7x growth in Central govt debt since FY15

Our Bureau
Mumbai

In a clear sign that the States are increasingly relying on market loans to finance deficits, State government securities (SGS) outstanding has surged roughly five-fold, far outpacing the 2.7x growth in Central government debt (via government security/ G-Sec) since FY15.

SGS VOLUMES
However, SGS volumes continue to remain at a fraction of G-Sec volumes despite large issuance, according to a report by Vedartha, the AIF & PMS brand under Bandhan AMC.

“India’s State government debt is rapidly taking on a larger role in the country’s overall sovereign borrowing profile. SGS now account for a markedly higher share of sovereign issuances. Historically, the Central government’s borrowing far outstripped that of States. But



HIGHER SHARE. Along with the rising debt issuance, States are also shifting towards longer-dated borrowings

over the last decade, this gap has narrowed significantly,” according to the report.

Annual State borrowings have climbed to about ₹12 lakh crore in FY2026E (estimated), and it is now approaching parity with Central government’s annual borrowings.

In short, the States are increasingly relying on market loans to finance deficits, fundamentally altering the over-

all demand-supply dynamics of India’s bond market, according to Vedartha’s assessment.

Along with the rising debt issuance, States are also shifting towards longer-dated borrowings.

In FY26, the weighted-average maturity of SGS issuance is expected to be around 16 years, which was around 11 years in FY20.

Over half of all issuances

are in tenors beyond 10 years now. “This extension is part deliberate and part opportunistic to manage refinancing risk as well as to lock lower yields in the current interest rate down-cycle for longer tenors” said Bhupendra Meel, Chief Investment Officer-Alternates (Fixed Income), Vedartha by Bandhan AMC.

The report noted that the combination of buy-and-hold ownership, larger issuance size and longer tenors, along with fragmented issuances and tenor buckets, is leading to persistent illiquidity and higher term premiums.

“SGS volume continues to remain at a fraction of G-Sec volumes despite large issuance. These characteristics deter active traders, making SGS more suitable for long-term investors or roll-down strategies,” said the report. Investors must, therefore, emphasise on exit-liquidity, careful State/tenor selection and adequate spreads.

The report said the opportunities are most attractive for investors when yields are wide enough to compensate for underlying State credit risk-premium and liquidity constraints.

POLICY REFORMS

The Vedartha report recommended several policy reforms to address the aforementioned issues, including a primary proposal to create a single standardised yield curve for SGS, whereby the RBI could define 8-10 benchmark maturities for all States and mandate them to issue only in those common tenors.

The report also suggested strictly limiting new ISIN creation (for example, to 12 per State/year) to curb fragmentation.

Further, a large majority of each State’s borrowing (example 60 per cent) should be done through reissuances of its benchmark securities, greatly reducing outstanding ISIN count over time.

Positive capital flows lend support to rupee despite global headwinds

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl research bureau

The rupee traded largely flat last week. Several factors were at play, which effectively kept the currency in a sideways trend. On Tuesday, it closed at 90.95. According to NSDL data, net FPI in-

RUPEE WEEKLY VIEW.

flows over the past week stood at \$1.2 billion, offering a cushion to the domestic currency and helping it absorb external pressures. However, global cues turned less favourable.

The US Core PCE Price Index rose 0.4 per cent month-on-month in December, higher than the expected 0.3 per cent. This marked the sharpest monthly increase since February last year, reinforcing expectations that the Fed may remain cautious on rate cuts. Such data tends to support the dollar and cap gains in emerging market currencies and rupee are no exception.

Meanwhile, crude oil prices have moved higher. Brent crude futures (now at

about \$71/barrel) rose nearly 6 per cent last week and is trading above its key technical level, indicating a bullish bias. Given India’s dependence on oil imports, sustained strength in crude prices can increase dollar demand and weigh on the rupee.

In addition, uncertainty around trade tariffs and geopolitical developments, including US-Iran tensions, continue to keep the risk appetite fragile, a backdrop that is typically unfavourable for the Indian currency. Overall, positive flows are providing support though external headwinds remain.

CHART

The rupee, which was trading between 90.45 and 90.80, slipped below the support at 90.80 last Thursday. However, there was no follow-through sell-off. The price action now shows that the rupee has found a new range within 90.65 and 91.

So, for the near-term, the key levels to watch out for are 90.45 and 91. A breach of this price band will lend us cues about the direction of the next trend. A breakout of

90.45 can lift the rupee to 90.20 and 90. But in case the support at 91 is breached, we will most likely see a decline to 91.80 and 92.

The movement in the local currency also depends on the dollar index. This index has been bullish recently. After laying a good foundation at 96.80, it has rallied to the current level of 97.90.

However, it now faces the 50-day moving average resistance at 98. If the dollar index surpasses this, it can eye 99.40 or even 100. In such a case, the rupee is likely to breach the support at 91.

On the other hand, if the dollar index retracts, the nearest support is at 97.35. A breach of this can drag it to 97. If this occurs, the rupee can appreciate above 90.45 and possibly move towards 90.20 and 90. Overall, the rupee is consolidating as capital inflows offset firm dollar and rising crude prices.

The 90.45-91 range remains key; a break above 90.45 could lift the currency towards 90.20-90, while a move below 91 may push it to 91.80-92, particularly if the dollar index strengthens further.

‘Per capita income acceleration faster than GDP growth rate’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The acceleration in India’s per capita income growth has been faster than GDP growth, with the decline in population growth being an important factor contributing to this trend, according to RBI Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta.



RBI Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta

RISE IN POPULATION

India’s population growth has traditionally been significantly higher than that of the world.

However, over the years, it has declined at a faster rate than the global rate, and since 2014, on par with the growth rate in world population, she said at the 14th Foundation Day Lecture of the Centre for Development Studies (Thiruvananthapuram) on February 20.

“India has experienced a rapid decline in fertility rates since the 1980s. While the death rate has been declining too and has fallen below world average, the pace of decline in fertility rate has

been faster than the decline in death rate, resulting in a slowing rate of population growth,” said Gupta.

“These trends are indicative of the impact of increasing prosperity and education levels on demography. Going by international experience, these trends are likely to continue in the years to come, aiding a rapid increase in per capita incomes,” said Gupta.

She noted that from a modest level of \$274 in 1981, and \$306 in 1991, India’s per capita income had increased nearly 10-fold to \$2,700 in 2024.

“From 1981, it took about 23 years to double the per

capita income, whereas in the subsequent 22 years, it has increased almost five-fold. As per October 2025 forecasts in the World Economic Outlook of the IMF, per capita income is projected to increase to \$2,818 in 2025, \$3,051 in 2026 and \$4,346 in 2030,” she said.

Gupta observed that since the early 1990s, the economy has been growing much faster than the rest of the world. As a result, the share of the Indian economy in the global economy has increased about three times, from about 1.1 per cent in 1991 to 3.5 per cent in 2024. The differential in growth rates has further widened in the last decade or so.

GDP GROWTH

Meanwhile, India’s per capita GDP, as a percentage of world per capita GDP, had also increased three-fold, from 7 per cent in 1991 to close to 20 per cent in 2024. These are in current US dollar terms; in purchasing power parity (PPP) terms, India’s per capita GDP relative to world per capita GDP is much larger.

TRAI proposes lower entry barriers for new players, uniform 35% spectrum cap

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) on Tuesday released recommendations on the auction of radio frequency spectrum in the bands identified for International Mobile Telecommunications (IMT).

It proposed lower entry barriers for new players and a uniform 35 per cent spectrum cap to safeguard competition in the telecom sector.

It recommended auction for the entire available spectrum in the 600 MHz, 800 MHz, 900 MHz, 1800 MHz, 2100 MHz, 2300 MHz, 2500 MHz, 3300 MHz and 26 GHz frequency bands in the forthcoming auction.

SPECTRUM CAP

A uniform spectrum cap of 35 per cent has been recommended across low, mid and high-frequency bands, including 600 MHz, sub-1 GHz bands, 1800-2500 MHz bands, 3300 MHz, 26 GHz and 37-40 GHz, with no requirement for operators already exceeding the cap to



surrender existing holdings. “The Department of Telecommunications should immediately initiate action for taking back the spectrum held with the telecom service providers, which are engaged in corporate insolvency resolution process under Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, and such spectrum should be put to auction in the forthcoming spectrum auction,” it said.

TELECOM CIRCLE

The spectrum in the frequency bands identified for IMT should be auctioned on telecom circle/metro area basis with a validity period of 20 years, it said, adding that

Simultaneous Multiple Round Auction (SMRA)-based spectrum auction should also be continued.

The TRAI recommendations also said considering the importance of the 6 GHz (upper) band, it should be kept reserved for IMT.

However, it noted that the available frequency ranges in the 6 GHz (upper) band, namely 6425-6725 MHz and 7025-7125 MHz, should not be put to auction in the forthcoming auction.

The issue of auctioning the spectrum in the 6 GHz (upper) band should be re-examined after considering the outcome of WRC-27, it added.

milma
Malabar Regional Co-Operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd.
Central Products Dairy, Naduvattom, North Baysore
Kozhikode-673 015, Phone: 0495-2414111
Email: ckdsk@malabarmilma.coop
No.01/CPD/118/ 2025-26 24/02/2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders are invited for the supply of one number PH meter (sleeve type electrode-suitable for viscous products) at Milma Central Products Dairy, Naduvattom. The bid document with technical specification, terms and conditions will be available from 25/02/2026 to 11/03/2026 at Central Products Dairy Naduvattom. For more details, Ph-9496714922.

Ancillary Unit (I/c)

COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
CIAL/IN/2025-26/02-01 **REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS** 25.02.2026
Cochin International Airport Ltd (CIAL) invites sealed proposals from eligible entities for selection of a **Point of Presence (PoP)** for implementation and servicing of the National Pension System (NPS)- Corporate Model for its employees.
Proposals are invited from Scheduled Commercial Banks(Nationalized / Indian Private Sector Banks) and PFRODA - registered Pension Fund Managers holding valid PoP registration under NPS with active CRA tie-up.

Scope	Employees	Period of Appointment	Last Date of Submission
Selection of PoP for Corporate NPS implementation and servicing at CIAL	541 (as on 31.01.2026)	3 Years	27.03.2026

For more details, visit our website <https://www.cial.aero/tenders> Sd/- Managing Director

VENLON ENTERPRISES LIMITED
Regd. Office & Works : 26 (P & Plot No 2, Belavadi Industrial Area, Hunsur Road, Mysuru - 570 018, in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and Rules made thereunder and SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations") and other relevant provisions, to transact the special business as set out in the Notice of EGM.
The Notice of the EGM along with Explanatory Statement and remote e-voting details have been sent in electronic mode to the members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/Depositories. The cut-off date for determining the eligibility of shareholders for voting is Friday, March 06, 2026. The date of completion of sending email of the notices to the shareholders is February 17, 2026. These documents are also available on Company's website <https://venlonenterprises.co.in/>.
Members who have not registered their email ID with the Company / Depository, please follow below instructions to register your email ID for obtaining EGM Notice and logindetails for e-voting.
Members holding shares in demat mode are requested to register/update their email address with the relevant Depository Participant (DP) and register your email address as per the process advised by the DP.
Pursuant to Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 and Regulation 44 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the Company has offered e-voting facility to its members in respect of the business to be transacted at the EGM. The remote e-voting period commences on Tuesday, March 10, 2026 at 09:00 A.M. (IST) and ends on Thursday, March 12, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST). No remote e-voting shall be allowed beyond the said date and time. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter. The members, whose names appear in the Register of Members / Beneficial Owners as on the cut-off date i.e., March 06, 2026, are entitled to vote on the resolutions set forth in the Notice of the EGM.
The remote e-voting facility will be provided by Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL). The members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the EGM may also attend the EGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the member, the member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.
The Chairman shall, at the EGM, at the end of discussion on the resolution on which voting is to be held, allow voting with the assistance of scrutinizer, by use of polling paper for all those members who are present at the EGM but have not cast their votes by availing the remote e-voting facility.
The Company has appointed, S. J. Madhwaraj, Advocate, as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting and ballot voting at the EGM in a fair and transparent manner.
Any query or grievance may be addressed to the Company at gdvenlon@gmail.com or to RTA at helpdesk@computechsharecap.in.

For Venlon Enterprises Limited Sd/-
G D Ramarao
Company Secretary

Date : February 17, 2026
Place : Mysore

भारतीय बागान प्रबन्ध संस्थान बेंगलुरु
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF PLANTATION MANAGEMENT BENGALURU
(An Autonomous Organization of the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, GOI)

Recruitment Notification

Applications are invited from academicians and industry professionals for the following **Teaching and Non-Teaching** positions on regular or contractual basis.

Professor (General Management / International Trade / Agri-Export Management), Assistant Professor (Finance & Accounting / HR / Economics) Placement Officer, Executive (Corporate Relations & Placements) Office Associates and Civil Engineer (On contract).

The details of Job description can be obtained from website www.iipmb.edu.in Eligible candidates may apply through online as per the prescribed format on or before **30th March 2026**.

Date: 25/02/2026
Notification No.:02/2026

DIRECTOR

PITTI ENGINEERING LIMITED
Regd. Office: 6-3-648/401, IVth Floor, Padmaja Landmark, Somajiguda, Hyderabad - 500 082, Telangana, India
Ph: 040-23312774, Email : shares@pitti.in, Website: www.pitti.in
CIN : L29253TG1983PLC004141

NOTICE FOR THE ATTENTION OF MEMBERS OF THE COMPANY

Notice is hereby given pursuant to Sections 110 and 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, Regulation 44 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, Secretarial Standards on General Meetings, and the applicable MCA Circulars (General Circulars 14/2020, 17/2020, 09/2024, and 03/2025), that the Company is conducting a Postal Ballot through remote e-voting only to seek Members' approval for the special business detailed in the Postal Ballot Notice.

As per the MCA Circulars, the Postal Ballot Notice will be sent only via email to Members whose email IDs are registered with the Company or their respective Depository Participants ("DPs"). No physical notices will be dispatched. Members shall convey their assent or dissent exclusively through remote e-voting, as detailed in the Postal Ballot Notice.

The Notice will be available on the Company's website (www.pitti.in), the websites of BSE (www.bseindia.com), NSE (www.nseindia.com), and the e-voting platform of MUFG Intime India Private Limited (www.in.mfms.mufg.com).
Registration / Update of Email ID and KYC Details

- Members Holding Shares in Physical Mode
Members who have not registered/updated their email ID or KYC details may submit Form ISR 1 to:
MUFG Intime India Private Limited
C 101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400 083
Tel : +91 8108116767, Email: investor.helpdesk@in.mfms.mufg.com
Form ISR 1 is available at: <https://www.pitti.in/api/investor-related/download/Form%20ISR-1.pdf?d=535&disposition=inline>
- Members Holding Shares in Dematerialized Mode
Members holding shares in demat form may update their email ID / KYC details by contacting their respective Depository Participants.

E Voting Period

Starts on :	Ends on :	Cut off Date:
Friday, 6 March 2026 (9:00 a.m. IST)	Saturday, 4 April 2026 (5:00 p.m. IST)	Friday, 27 February 2026

Members holding shares in physical or demat form as on the cut off date may vote electronically. The e voting system will be disabled thereafter.

For Pitti Engineering Limited Sd/-
Mary Monica Braganza
Company Secretary & Chief Compliance Officer
FCS: 5532

Place: Hyderabad
Date : February 24, 2026

ISGEC HEAVY ENGINEERING LIMITED
CIN: L23423HR1933PLC000097
Registered Office: Radaur Road, Yamunanagar - 135001, Haryana
Telephone: +91-1732-661061 / 661158
Email: roynr@isgect.com, Website: www.isgect.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT

NOTICE is hereby given to the Members of Isgec Heavy Engineering Limited ("Company"), pursuant to the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act") and Rules made thereunder ("Rules"), the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India ["SS-2"] read with the guidelines prescribed by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ["MCA"] for holding general meetings/ conducting postal ballot process through e-voting vide various general circulars issued by MCA ["Circulars"], including any statutory modification(s) or amendment(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force, approval of the members of the Company is being sought by Resolutions by way of Postal Ballot through remote e-voting process ("remote e-voting") only.

In accordance with applicable laws, the Company has completed the dispatch of Notice of Postal Ballot, by electronic means only to those members whose names appeared in the Register of Members/ List of Beneficial Owners and whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company/Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, i.e. Alankit Assignments Limited (RTA), as on Friday, February 20, 2026 ["cut-off date"]. The said notice is also available on the website of the Company, www.isgect.com, stock exchanges, namely BSE Ltd. (BSE) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) where Company's equity shares are listed at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, as well as on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

In accordance with the provisions of the MCA Circulars, physical copy of the Notice of Postal Ballot along with the Postal Ballot form and the pre-paid business reply envelope are not sent to the members for this Postal Ballot and member can vote through e-voting.

Voting rights shall be reckoned on the paid-up value of share registered in the name of the members as on the cut-off date. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat the Notice for information purpose only.

Instructions for e-voting:
The Company has engaged the services of National Securities Depositories Limited (NSDL) enabling members to cast their votes electronically and in a secure manner. A detailed procedure for casting of votes through remote e-voting has been provided in the Notice. The remote e-voting shall commence on **Thursday, February 26, 2026, from 09:00 a.m. (IST) and end on Friday, March 27, 2026, at 05:00 p.m. (IST)**. During this period, Members holding shares either in physical or electronic form as on cut-off date shall cast their vote electronically. Members are requested to accord their ASSENT (FOR) or DISSENT (AGAINST) through the remote e-voting process not later than **Friday, March 27, 2026, at 05:00 p.m. (IST)**. Once the vote on the resolution is cast by Member, the Member shall not be able to change it subsequently.

In case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on: 022-4986 7000 and 022-2499 7000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Senior Manager at pallavid@nsdl.co.in or at evoting@nsdl.com.

The resolutions, if passed by the requisite majority, shall be deemed to have been passed on the **Friday, March 27, 2026, i.e., the last date of remote e-voting process**. The Results of voting through Postal Ballot along with Scrutinizer's Report will be announced on or before **Sunday, March 29, 2026**. The same will be displayed on the website of the Company, www.isgect.com, stock exchanges, namely BSE and NSE where Company's equity shares are listed at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, as well as on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

Members who have not updated their e-mail addresses are requested to register the same in respect of the shares held by them in electronic form with the Depository through their Depository Participant and in respect of shares held in physical form by writing to Company's RTA either by email at rtat@alankit.com or by post at Alankit House, 4E/2, Jhandewalan Extn., New Delhi-110055.

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QUICKLY.

Noida airport ties up with Mann Fleet Partners



Noida: Noida International Airport announced the selection of Mann Fleet Partners as its mobility services partner to provide comprehensive ground transportation solutions for passengers. The airport said that the partnership aimed to ensure seamless and efficient connectivity to and from the upcoming airport through a range of integrated transport services. The contract includes rental car services, premium pick-up and drop-off facilities at the arrival and departure kerbs to minimise walking distances, and the operation, management and maintenance of bus shuttle services on the airport campus. [»](#)

SriLankan Airlines plans flights to Ahmedabad



New Delhi: Seeking to strengthen its presence in India, SriLankan Airlines plans to start direct flights between Colombo and Ahmedabad in the next three months, as well as enhance its partnership with Air India. Currently, the airline has 89 weekly flights from Colombo to nine cities in India, and Ahmedabad would be its 10th Indian destination. Subject to regulatory approvals, SriLankan Airlines plans to start four weekly flights connecting Colombo and Ahmedabad. The carrier has flights to Chennai, Mumbai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, Kochi, Thiruvananthapuram, Madurai and Tiruchirappalli. [»](#)

Centre sets ₹27,500 cr monetisation target for civil aviation under NMP 2.0

PRIVATE PARTICIPATION. Currently, 11 airports have been identified for leasing during the five-year period

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The next round of airport leasing (divestment) just got a boost, with the Centre setting a monetisation target of ₹27,500 crore for the civil aviation sector under the National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP) 2.0 for FY26-30. Currently, 11 airports have been identified for monetisation (leasing) during the five-year period. The proposal is being considered by the Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC). These airports include Varanasi, Bhubaneswar, Amritsar, Indore, Raipur, Tiruchirappalli, Kozhikode, Coimbatore, Ranchi, Jodhpur and Gaya. NMP 2.0 framework covers operational, revenue-

generating airports and select equity divestments in aviation-related public sector entities. The framework provides for structured private participation, while ownership of core airport assets will remain with the government.

SALE OF AIRPORTS Besides, the framework states that the programme does not involve the outright sale of airports. Instead, airports will be offered under long-term concession agreements for a fixed duration, after which the assets will revert to the public authority. According to the framework, the primary model proposed is the time-tested operation, maintenance and development agreement (OMDA). In this structure, private



GENERATING REVENUE. The framework provides for structured private participation, while ownership of core airport assets will remain with the government

concessionaires will operate and maintain airports, undertake capital expenditure for modernisation and expansion, and pay upfront concession fees or share revenue with the government or the airport authority. Further, long-term public private partnership (PPP) concessions will also be de-

ployed, typically spanning 20-50 years. In addition, select strategic stake-sales or equity divestments may be undertaken through initial public offering or follow-on public offering routes. Notably, under the previous National Monetisation Pipeline covering FY22-25, the civil aviation sector had a

monetisation target of ₹13,500 crore. According to official estimates, the ₹27,500-crore total monetisation value includes upfront concession payments, the present value of future revenue share payable to the government or public sector undertakings, and committed private sector investment. However, after adjusting for depreciation of airport assets during the concession period, the aggregate monetisation value is estimated at ₹22,500 crore. According to projections for FY26-30, the majority of proceeds are expected to accrue to airport authorities and public sector undertakings. Moreover, some inflows are projected beyond FY30 based on the concession structure.

Alternate airports to hit 40 m passenger capacity in 2026

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India's operational and upcoming alternate airports are expected to have an annual capacity of 40 million passengers by this year-end, with their next phase of expansion over the next four fiscals, said Crisil Ratings. They are poised to cater to 45-50 million passengers annually by FY30, driven by pent-up demand, given the capacity constraints at older airports and expansion of catchment areas. Airport traffic in India is projected to rise from 415 million passengers this fiscal to 580 million by FY30, at a compound annual growth rate of 8-9 per cent, driven by strong economic activity, untapped demand and easing of airport capacity constraints at select metros. "The older airports in the MMR and the NCR are operating at close to their design capacity, with combined util-

isation at 87 per cent last fiscal. They have limited options for large expansionary capex due to space constraints," said Ankit Hakhu, Director, Crisil Ratings. **TIMELY RAMP-UP** "Alternate airports in metros are expected to cater to 20-25 per cent of the total traffic in their regions by FY30, ensuring viability of these airports as demand for air travel grows and connectivity to these airports improves. However, timely ramp-up will be crucial for scaling up aeronautical and non-aeronautical revenues of these airports within their first control periods." According to the agency, airports in other metro cities, such as Bengaluru and Hyderabad, have room for expansion with utilisation against design capacity at 65 per cent last fiscal. Globally, metro cities with multiple large airports have "done well, such as in New York/New Jersey and London".

Domestic air passenger traffic growth projected to recover to 6-8%: ICRA

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

India's domestic air passenger traffic is expected to grow 6-8 per cent to reach 175-179 million passengers in 2026-27, rating agency ICRA estimated on Tuesday. In December 2025, ICRA had revised its domestic air passenger growth estimates to 0-3 per cent for 2025-26 from the 4-6 per cent envisaged earlier. As per the rating agency, the international air passenger traffic growth for Indian carriers is expected to remain relatively stronger, aided by low base effect, expanding e-visa or visa-on-arrival coverage, and the Government of India's focus on developing theme-based and iconic tourist destinations. Consequently, ICRA es-



MORE FLIERS. International air passenger traffic is expected to grow at 7-9 per cent for 2025-26 and 8-10 per cent for 2026-27

timated international air passenger traffic growth at 7-9 per cent for 2025-26 and 8-10 per cent for 2026-27. Moreover, ICRA projected the net loss of the Indian aviation industry to reduce to ₹11,000-₹12,000 crore in 2026-27 from an elevated ₹17,000-₹18,000 crore in 2025-26.

The current fiscal year has seen a period of modest domestic air passenger traffic growth due to cross-border escalations, weather-related disruptions, travel hesitancy following the June 2025 air-crash, the impact on business travel owing to the headwinds stemming from the elevated US tariffs, and

The net loss of the Indian aviation industry is projected to reduce to ₹11,000-12,000 cr in 2026-27 from ₹17,000-18,000 crore in 2025-26

operational disruptions at IndiGo in December 2025.

OUTLOOK STABLE According to Kinjal Shah, Senior Vice-President & Co-Group Head, ICRA, the rating agency maintained a 'stable' outlook for the Indian aviation industry, supported by expectations of modest growth in domestic air passenger traffic and a gradually-improving operat-

ing environment, despite near-term challenges. "The Indian aviation industry is expected to report a net loss of ₹17,000-₹18,000 crore in 2025-26, significantly higher than the estimated net loss of around ₹5,500 crore in 2024-25. However, the same is likely to reduce to ₹11,000-₹12,000 crore in 2026-27, led by growth in domestic air passenger traffic and expected normalisation of operations post disruptions seen in 2025-26 that resulted in flight cancellations and passenger refunds," Shah said. "The industry's debt metric, which weakened in 2025-26 with an estimated interest cover of 0.7-0.9 times from 1.8 times in 2024-25, is also expected to improve to 1.3-1.5 times in 2026-27, despite increasing debt linked with new aircraft deliveries."

Besides, ICRA cited that the industry saw around 4 per cent capacity addition in CY25 and the total number of aircraft stood at 865 as on December 31, 2025. Various industry players have announced large aircraft purchase orders and, as per the indicative numbers, the total pending deliveries stand at more than 1,700 as on January 31, 2026, which are likely to be received over the next 10 years. A large part of these orders is towards replacement of old aircraft with new fuel-efficient ones, ICRA said. "Engine failures and supply chain challenges resulted in grounding of 20-22 per cent of the total industry fleet as of September 2023. The same has come down to 13-15 per cent as of February 2026, corresponding to 117 aircraft," Shah said.

Singapore Airlines Q3 profit tumbles

Reuters

Singapore Airlines posted a nearly 69 per cent slide in third-quarter net profit on Tuesday due to the absence of last year's one-off gain from the Air India-Vistara merger and rising fuel costs. The airline's share of losses from associated companies climbed by \$163 million to \$178 million, reflecting a full-quarter share of Air India's losses this year, compared with only one month in the year-ago period. Its expenditure rose to \$4.71 billion compared with \$4.59 billion. Record global travel demand kept older aircraft in service, pushing up fuel, maintenance, engine-leasing and inventory costs.



NABARD
Presents

thehindubusinessline.
AGRI & COMMODITY SUMMIT 2026

Women: Pillar of the Rural Economy

The fifth edition of *the hindu businessline's* Agri and Commodity Summit 2026 is focussed on women and their significant role in India's rural economy.

Celebrating the International Year of Women Farmers, the event will feature engaging discussions on women's empowerment in agriculture and the financial challenges faced by women farmers. The event will also spotlight inspiring success stories of women who have made significant strides in agriculture.

The grand finale will be a fireside chat with a distinguished agribusiness CEO.

**Friday, February 27, 2026
9:30 AM - 5:00 PM**

LIMITED REGISTRATIONS ONLY

The Leela Palace, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi

To register, visit
thbl.news/AGRS2026PA
or scan the QR code



SESSION LINE-UP



10.40 AM
Inaugural Address
Devesh Chaturvedi
Secretary, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India



11.00 AM
Special Address
Shaji K. V.
Chairman, NABARD

Session 1 : 11:15 AM
Silent Architects of the Rural Economy
Sarbani Bose, CoE Lead, Gender Equality, PRADAN
Chhavi Rajawat, Former Sarpanch, Soda Village, Rajasthan (2010-2020)
Sanjiv Kanwar, Managing Director, Yara South Asia and Country Head, Yara India
Kalyani Singh, Entrepreneur, Better Life Farming Alliance
Moderated by Shishir Sinha, Associate Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 2 : 12:00 NOON
Seeds of Funding
Anupam Gupta, CBO, Kissandhan
Tarana, Farmer, Arakote Valley, Uttarakhand
Ravi Kumar, Lead-Smallholder Farming, South-East Asia, Bayer AG
Ajay Kumar Jha, Deputy General Manager (Product Development and Marketing), State Bank of India
Moderated by Subramani Ra Mancombu, Consulting Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 3 : 12:45 PM
From Field Work to Entrepreneurship
Aruna Debbarma, Lakhpati Didi, Tripura Rural Livelihood Mission
Vaishali Ghuge, Member, Swayam Shikshan Prayog
Moderated by Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, Hyderabad, *the hindu businessline*

Session 4 : 3:00 PM
Precious Metals: Beyond Aam Aadmi's Reach
Kavita Chacko, Research Head, India, World Gold Council
Jateen N Trivedi, VP, Commodity and Currency Research, LKP Securities
Tarun Kanwar, Director, Navrattan Jewellers, Delhi.
Moderated by Lokeshwarri S K, Data Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 5 : 3:45 PM
Fireside Chat
Brahmani Nara, Executive Director, Heritage Foods,
with Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Presenting Partner

Associate Partners

Banking Partner

Media Partner



A photograph showing several walnuts. One walnut is cracked open, revealing the light-colored, textured kernel inside. Another walnut is partially cracked. A large, green, serrated walnut leaf is positioned behind the walnuts. The background is a solid light blue.

Return 20.8% (per kg)

Feb 24, 25 Feb 23, 26

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI	
Parsiphat [5]	7.02	6555	7.00	7.12	6.45	144505.09	27.46	6.50	-	6.51	
Spaspathu Cot	954.10	9655	9745	9750	9400	55	9750	584.00	-	-	
Spaspati aer	51.70	50.90	51.70	51.75	50.20	6819	63.50	38.64	-	-	
Patel Ind [1]	128.50	122.41	122.80	122.80	122.80	155.28	2011.00	186.00	-	-	
Patel eng [1]	27.93	28.32	28.50	28.75	28.70	127276.69	46.59	26.16	8	28.35	
Patel Retail	181.87	194.70	181.99	182.99	178.00	76.54	380.00	169.91	-	-	
PayTM	1173.10	1137.01	1169.10	1169.30	1165.31	1163.18	651.50	-	-	-	
PC Jeweller [1]	1486.20	1484.60	1486.20	1486.20	1486.20	1486.20	1486.20	1486.20	-	-	
PC Jeweller [1]	9.97	10.07	9.97	10.13	9.93	933346.44	19.65	8.66	-	10.08	
PBS Bank	33.54	310.50	305.95	310.10	299.15	1562.99	44.15	254.50	-	-	
PDS	25.50	25.50	25.50	25.50	25.50	25.50	25.50	25.50	-	-	
Penland Ltd [1]	18.34	17.97	18.34	18.44	17.75	2554.1	40.00	17.75	-	-	
PENNAR IND [5]	147.93	141.92	146.58	147.49	140.41	1122.12	279.80	141.20	19	141.85	
PEVSTEENT [1]	482.50	482.50	482.50	482.50	482.50	482.50	482.50	482.50	-	-	
PETROLONG	366.75	367.95	366.50	367.20	367.20	4742.96	163.70	13	308.10	-	
Pfizer Ltd	506.50	5084.50	5096.00	5133.00	5003.70	14.03	5887.95	3742.90	30	5086.55	
PG Electro [1]	60.17	61.33	60.12	61.09	60.12	1369.36	1008.00	471.15	140	61.39	
PGF India [1]	128.50	128.10	128.60	130.74	128.10	100.13	293.70	121.25	-	-	
Phoenix Mills [1]	1716.30	1692.60	1710.12	1720.67	1710.12	1710.12	1710.12	1710.12	-	-	
PhysicWall	99.07	91.05	97.09	97.92	98.62	286129.96	161.59	88.62	-	-	
Pyramid Ind [1]	35.50	310.70	310.70	310.70	310.70	310.70	310.70	310.70	-	-	
PiccadillyAard	58.40	59.95	57.50	57.92	55.00	74.53	80.55	53.15	-	-	
Pidlite [1]	148.10	1480.50	1475.10	1486.70	1470.00	641.63	1575.00	1310.08	65	1480.95	
Pine Labs	208.80	203.26	207.39	210.32	202.80	1688.64	104.00	192.81	-	-	
Pir Medico	32.20	82.10	82.80	83.50	81.50	147.00	74.10	76.10	-	-	
Piramal Phr	16.24	159.48	162.14	162.14	157.92	2663.23	249.05	148.31	-	-	
Pitti Eng [5]	89.80	89.25	89.80	89.80	89.35	11.65	121.00	67.20	32	88.870	
PJF Finance [1]	148.50	148.50	148.50	148.50	148.50	148.50	148.50	148.50	-	-	
Platinum	226.25	225.70	224.11	227.39	224.11	37.39	34.20	21.30	-	-	
Pm Gadgil Jw	55.50	55.50	55.50	55.50	54.80	93.11	70.10	47.80	-	-	
Pm Gils	78.70	77.63	78.00	78.40	77.30	113.84	73.55	-	-	-	
Pm Housing	32.20	82.10	82.80	83.50	81.50	147.00	74.10	76.10	-	-	
PNC Infra [1]	21.50	21.23	21.60	21.60	21.41	170.98	11.80	20.60	15	21.10	
Pokam Ind [1]	97.90	93.40	98.90	99.80	92.10	126.24	135.05	69.25	38	93.875	
Polycom Ltd	79.80	79.80	79.80	79.80	79.80	79.80	79.80	79.80	-	-	
Polyplex	84.18	80.875	81.00	81.50	80.62	50.20	136.60	77.50	38	80.810	
Ponavalifair	47.03	46.810	47.10	47.25	46.55	47.87	57.40	26.20	-	-	
Pondy Odeon	114.20	115.00	114.70	115.00	114.70	115.00	115.00	115.00	-	-	
Popular Veh	88.85	86.94	90.95	90.95	86.37	83.99	163.00	86.37	-	-	
Power Finan	11.80	41.30	41.30	42.05	40.75	8723.03	44.95	33.05	7	41.30	
Power Infra	340.70	340.70	340.70	340.70	340.70	340.70	340.70	340.70	-	-	
Power Instru	10.30	11.50	11.01	11.64	10.71	62.11	21.00	97.85	-	-	
Power Trad	168.31	165.50	168.28	168.30	163.01	127.91	206.00	134.85	12	165.65	
Prakash Ind [1]	202.10	212.43	207.10	212.43	212.43	43.72	143.14	168.84	22	212.820	
Prakash Energy	17.70	18.31	17.70	18.31	17.70	18.31	18.31	18.31	-	-	
Prati Ind [1]	39.35	30.35	39.30	39.30	30.30	60.20	61.65	59.10	27.05	36	
Prakash Ind [1]	13.87	15.55	13.80	14.00	13.41	49.50	19.00	11.00	-	-	
Prakash Ind [1]	12.70	12.70	12.70	12.70	12.70	12.70	12.70	12.70	-	-	
Premam	14.44	14.51	14.41	14.42	14.30	13.90	14.07	26.30	13.60	48	
Precision Wr [1]	30.06	30.27	30.00	30.05	29.52	122.81	38.20	118.35	42	30.195	
Preraj Ind [1]	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	-	-	
Preraj Ind [1]	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	-	-	
Premier ELEC	47.00	48.67	47.50	48.60	48.60	11.96	68.20	30.95	56	48.665	
prestige Est	148.90	142.50	147.60	148.30	148.30	1014.23	1812.40	1048.30	63.90	142.50	
Pricol Ltd [1]	63.90	63.90	63.90	63.90	63.90	63.90	63.90	63.90	-	-	
Prima Ind [1]	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	-	-	
Prince Pipe	25.39	25.04	25.80	26.33	24.78	10.80	37.70	22.95	-	-	
Prime Cement	12.53	12.54	12.50	12.54	12.54	16.52	12.75	10.80	-	-	
Prima Ind [1]	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	14.80	-	-	
Procter&Gam	11494.00	11493.00	11475.00	11537.00	11450.00	57.44	1436.60	1131.35	43	11481.55	
ProstarInfra	15.35	15.25	15.60	15.70	15.10	16.68	25.19	10.80	-	-	
Prostar EGov	60.70	59.40	60.00	60.05	58.50	25.04	14.84	58.50	-	-	
Prostar Corp	74.60	74.60	74.60	74.60	74.60	74.60	74.60	74.60	-	-	
PSPPROJECT	76.40	74.20	76.80	76.80	73.65	27.46	103.80	61.25	82	74.15	
PTC Ind [1]	17932.00	17897.00	17778.00	18001.00	17671.00	1.67	1987.00	979.90	-	-	
PUNJAB SER	32.94	32.94	32.94	32.94	32.94	32.94	32.94	32.94	-	-	
Pudumjee [2]	41.12	40.96	41.15	41.15	40.99	39.31	33.10	68.33	37.55	9	41.11
Punjabam Pap [1]	82.33	81.20	82.40	82.70	80.51	90.55	106.85	80.46	8	82.30	
PUNJICORP	127.10	124.56	127.10	127.10	124.56	127.10	127.10	127.10	-	-	
Punjab Ind [1]	13.90	13.10	13.90	13.90	13.10	20.58	26.37	16.45	69.55	15	
PUNJABIND	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	-	-	
Punjab Ind [1]	13.90	13.10	13.90	13.90	13.10	20.58	26.37	16.45	69.55	15	
PUNJABIND	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	26.44	-	-	
Paravankam [1]	24.24	21.88	23.10	22.40	21.73	29.51	33.85	20.85	-	-	
PVR Inox	1031.90	1032.10	1021.00	1034.90	1006.75	292.97	1245.70	838.00	-	-	

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
Schand Co [5]	158.23	153.80	159.89	159.89	153.16	32.67	257.50	138.55	61	154.00
SchlossBanc	435.27	437.80	440.00	440.00	430.00	70.84	474.00	382.50	-	-
SE INVEST [1]	35.17	35.22	34.45	35.45	34.45	345.91	25.10	29.40	15	35.23
Senel Fin [1]	229.65	222.95	228.50	229.10	221.00	344.82	70.70	22.40	-	-
Senores Phar	73.80	77.25	79.95	79.95	77.25	123.19	87.50	44.00	-	-
SEPC	8.34	7.94	8.34	8.64	7.80	7.80	7.80	7.80	-	-
Servotex Pwr	238.19	240.10	240.10	241.00	237.01	19.43	43.75	22.01	-	-
Servotex Ind	238.19	240.10	240.10	241.00	237.01	19.43	43.75	22.01	-	-
SFL [5]	568.85	555.85	565.50	567.00	552.70	47.57	778.00	498.05	83	555.15
SG Mart L	432.90	430.40	430.00	435.40	425.48	128.47	448.00	313.10	-	-
SG Mart Ind	432.90	430.40	430.00	435.40	425.48	128.47	448.00	313.10	-	-
Sh Renu Spd [1]	23.53	23.20	23.41	23.50	23.10	2059.20	35.84	22.86	-	23.23
Sh T Balajee	32.30	30.82	31.35	32.50	29.96	80.24	65.55	29.96	-	-
Shakti Ind [1]	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	-	-
Shakti PUMPS	256.70	537.55	557.00	558.55	536.50	71.89	147.00	536.20	21	538.35
Shal MetaCo	4.86	4.77	4.89	4.93	4.72	237.14	5.55	2.80	-	-
Shakti Ind [1]	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	501.60	-	-
SHALIMAR P [1]	56.85	55.48	57.00	57.35	53.22	64.71	11.89	54.10	-	-
Shankara Bhd	10.40	99.97	103.88	103.88	99.05	106.87	311.50	99.50	5	100.10
Shankara Bhd	10.40	99.97	103.88	103.88	99.05	106.87	311.50	99.50	5	100.10
ShantGolInd	218.25	218.25	219.99	219.99	214.00	280.40	274.10	184.10	-	-
Sharda Corp	1174.70	1162.80	1169.00	1197.50	1137.00	20.55	1297.00	44.00	21	1163.15
Sharda M [2]	91.85	95.10	97.10	97.50	94.60	19.55	1258.00	62.50	17	95.80
Sharda M [2]	91.85	95.10	97.10	97.50	94.60	19.55	1258.00	62.50	17	95.80
ShivGidCem	72.23	71.76	72.71	72.71	70.12	169.68	10.70	64.99	-	-
Shilchar Text	3840.00	3765.10	3845.00	3870.00	3761.00	18.58	4350.00	2852.50	-	-
Shiv Gid C [1]	72.23	71.76	72.71	72.71	70.12	169.68	10.70	64.99	-	-
Shipping Cor	45.24	44.92	45.24	47.41	43.35	1242.94	30.34	42.85	-	-
Shivalki	55.25	47.85	50.10	50.10	47.85	50.10	50.10	50.10	-	-
Shivanki Ind	251.25	252.40	252.40	257.20	251.10	24.40	74.40	265.65	-	-
SHK	155.32	153.13	153.90	154.44	151.88	141.99	27.50	135.35	39	153.30
SHOOPER S [5]	333.50	315.90	330.00	330.00	313.00	97.36	588.50	313.00	316.65	-
Shree Cement	2659.00	2652.00	2649.00	2670.00	2620.00	28.32	2608.00	2389.00	55	2659.50
Shree Ram [1]	56.58	55.60	56.03	57.49	55.35	88.09	55.15	31.07	13	55.49
ShreeShip	40.45	40.10	40.20	40.70	39.80	51.73				